

Handbook of Krishna Consciousness



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[Total Pages : 6 + 125 = 131; 1/16 Demy Size]

Readers interested in the subject matter of this book are invited by the International Society for Krishna Consciousness, to correspond with its Secretary at the following address:

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First to Eleventh Printing	: 1997 - 2019, 63,000 copies
Twelfth Printing	: October 2022 - 3,000 copies

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ISBN : 81-283-0018-0

Published in India by the Sankirtan Seva Trust.

Printed by **Canara Prints**, Seegehalli, Bangalore.

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ISKCON Bangalore Daily Programme

Time	Programme	Song/mantras on page
4:15 am	Mangala Ārati (main temple)	13
4:35 am	Tulasī Pūja (main temple)	18-19
4:50 am	Narasimha Ārati (Śrī Narasimha temple)	16-17
5:05 am	Śrī Venkateśa Suprabhātam (Śrī Śrīnivāsa Govinda temple)	102
5:15 am	Japa (main temple)	
7:15 am	Darśana Ārati (main temple)	20-25
7:35 am	Darśana of Śrī Narasimha	16-17
7:40 am	Darśana of Śrī Śrīnivāsa Govinda	111
7:45 am	Prabhupāda Pūja (main temple)	26
8:15 am	Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam Class (lecture hall)	
6:45 pm	Tulasī Pūja (main temple)	18-19
7:00 pm	Sandhyā Ārati (main temple) & Śrī Narasimha Ārati	28
8:00 pm	Śayana Ārati & Pallaki Utsava	29

Special programme on Sunday (in the main temple):

5:15 pm	Bhajans
5:30 pm	Tulasī Pūja
7:00 pm	Sandhyā Ārati
8:15 pm	Śayana Ārati & Pallaki Utsava
9:00 pm	Darśana closes

Darshana remains closed between 1:00 pm and 4:15 pm everyday.

Introduction

Srila Prabhupada

His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada appeared in this world in 1896 in Calcutta, India. After completing his college education, he met his spiritual master, Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Gosvami, in 1922.

Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati, a prominent religious scholar and the founder of 64 *Gaudiya Mathas* (Vedic institutions), liked this educated young man and convinced him to dedicate his life to teaching Vedic knowledge. Srila Prabhupada became his student, and 11 years later (1933), at Allahabad, he became his formally initiated disciple.

At their first meeting, in 1922, Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura requested Srila Prabhupada to broadcast Vedic knowledge through the English language. In the years that followed, Srila Prabhupada wrote a commentary on the *Bhagavad-gita*, assisted the *Gaudiya Matha* in its work, and in 1944 began to write and publish an English biweekly magazine, *Back to Godhead*. This magazine is now being continued by Srila Prabhupada's disciples across the world and is published in many languages.

In recognition of Srila Prabhupada's erudition and devotion, the Gaudiya Vaishnava Society in India honored him in 1947 with the title "Bhaktivedanta." In 1950, at the age of 54, Srila Prabhupada retired from married life and lived in very humble circumstances in the historical medieval temple of Radha-Damodara at Vrindavana. There he engaged for several years in deep study and writing. He accepted the renounced order of life (*sannyasa*) in 1959. At Radha-Damodara,

Srila Prabhupada began work on his life's masterpiece: a multi-volume English translation of the 18,000-verse *Srimad-Bhagavatam* (*Bhagavata Purana*), with commentary. At that time he also wrote a short book, *Easy Journey to Other Planets*.

After publishing three volumes of the *Bhagavatam*, Srila Prabhupada went to the United States in 1965, to fulfill the mission of his spiritual master. Subsequently, His Divine Grace wrote more than 60 volumes of authoritative translations, commentaries, and summary studies of the philosophical and religious classics of India.

In 1965, when he first arrived by freighter in New York city, Srila Prabhupada was practically penniless. It was after almost a year of great difficulty that he established the International Society for Krishna Consciousness in July of 1966. By the time of his passing away on November 14, 1977, he had guided the Society and had seen it grow to a worldwide confederation of more than a hundred *ashramas*, schools, temples, institutes, and farm communities.

In 1968, Srila Prabhupada created New Vrindavana, a farm community in the hills of West Virginia. Inspired by the success of New Vrindavana, his students have since founded several similar communities throughout the world.

In 1972, His Divine Grace introduced the Vedic system of primary and secondary education in the West by founding the *gurukula* school in Dallas, Texas.

Srila Prabhupada's most significant contribution, however, is his books. Highly respected by the academic community for their authoritativeness, depth, and clarity, they are used as standard textbooks in numerous college courses. His writings have been translated into 28 languages. The Bhaktivedanta Book Trust,

established in 1972 exclusively to publish the works of His Divine Grace, has thus become the world's largest publisher of books in the field of Indian religion and philosophy.

In just 12 years, in spite of his advanced age, Srila Prabhupada circled the globe 14 times, lectured in six continents, and, despite such a vigorous schedule, he continued to rise hours before dawn every day to translate the Vedic texts into English. His writings constitute a veritable library of Vedic philosophy, religion, literature, and culture.

Read more at: www.iskconbangalore.org/srila-prabhupada

Who is Lord Chaitanya?

In the latter part of the fifteenth century, India's most extraordinary religious, cultural, and political reformer appeared in West Bengal. His name was Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, the founder of the modern-day Hare Krishna Movement.

Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, an incarnation of Krishna, introduced a revolutionary spiritual movement based on India's ancient Vedic literature. He swept aside the stifling restrictions of the caste system and allowed people everywhere to transcend social barriers and achieve the highest platform of spiritual enlightenment through the chanting of the Hare Krishna mantra.

India's Vedic scriptures had long predicted His birth in 1486 in Mayapur, India. As He grew to young manhood, Lord Chaitanya began to carry out His divine mission of allowing people in every station of life access to love of God. Sri Chaitanya taught that this awakening could be attained by the chanting of God's holy names, the Hare Krishna *mantra*: Hare Krishna, Hare Krishna, Krishna Krishna, Hare Hare Hare Rama, Hare Rama, Rama Rama, Hare Hare.

As He traveled throughout India, hundreds of thousands of people would join Him in massive chanting parties. Sri Chaitanya often recited to them a Sanskrit verse that described the essence of His teachings:

**harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam
kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva nāsty eva gatiṁ anyathā**

“In this Age of *Kali* there is no other means, no other means, no other means for self-realization than chanting the holy name, chanting the holy name, chanting the holy name of Lord Hari.”

After the *sankirtana* movement had gained popularity, a small group of envious men from His hometown decided to harass the Lord and His devotees. They decided to lie to the local Muslim magistrate (*Kazi*), saying that the Lord was violating Hindu doctrine. Subsequently the *Kazi*, named Nawab Hussain Shah, sent constables who stopped the devotees' chanting. In response, Chaitanya Mahaprabhu organized a 100,000-man civil disobedience party that chanted and danced down the roads of Navadvipa in violation of the magistrate's order.

After reaching the *Kazi*'s home, the Lord explained that the chanting of the Hare Krishna *mantra* was a bonafide Vedic method for worshipping God, especially in this age. The *Kazi*, moved by the Lord's purity, declared it an offense for anyone to interfere with the *sankirtana* movement from that time onward. Today, pilgrims still visit the tomb of the *Kazi* in Navadvipa to pay their respects.

The teachings of Sri Chaitanya form the philosophical basis of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON). In 1986, ISKCON members and millions of people throughout India and the world celebrated the 500th anniversary of the advent of Sri Chaitanya.

Chaitanya Mahaprabhu advocated a universal religion for all humanity, a scientific process of spiritual awakening that has spread across the globe.

Read more at: www.iskconbangalore.org/lord-chaitanya

1. Praṇāma Mantras

Śrīla Prabhupāda Praṇati

nama om viṣṇu-pādāya kṛṣṇa-preṣṭhāya bhū-tale
śrīmate bhaktivedānta-svāmin iti nāmine

I offer my respectful obeisances unto His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupāda, who is very dear to Lord Kṛṣṇa on this earth, having taken shelter at His lotus feet.

namas te sārāsvate deve gaura-vāṇī-pracāriṇe
nirviśeṣa-śūnyavādi-pāścātya-deśa-tāriṇe

Our respectful obeisances are unto you, O spiritual master, servant of Sarasvatī Gosvāmī. You are kindly preaching the message of Lord Caitanyadeva and delivering the Western countries, which are filled with impersonalism and voidism.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Praṇati

nama om viṣṇu-pādāya kṛṣṇa-preṣṭhāya bhū-tale
śrīmate bhaktisiddhānta-sarasvatīti nāmine

I offer my respectful obeisances unto His Divine Grace Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī Ṭhākura, who is very dear to Lord Kṛṣṇa, having taken shelter at His lotus feet.

śrī-vārṣabhānavī-devī-dayitāya kṛpābdhaye
kṛṣṇa-sambandha-vijñāna-dāyine prabhava namaḥ

I offer my respectful obeisances to Śrī Vārṣabhānavī-devī-dayita dāsa [another name of Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī], who is favored

by Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī and who is the ocean of transcendental mercy and the deliverer of the science of Kṛṣṇa.

**mādhuryojjvala-premāḍhya-śrī-rūpānuga-bhaktida-
śrī-gaura-karuṇā-śakti-vigrahāya namo 'stu te**

I offer my respectful obeisances unto you, the personified energy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's mercy, who delivers devotional service enriched with conjugal love of Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, coming exactly in the line of revelation of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

**namas te gaura-vāṇī-śrī-mūrtaye dīna-tāriṇe
rūpānuga-viruddhāpasiddhānta-dhvānta-hāriṇe**

I offer my respectful obeisances unto you, who are the personified teachings of Lord Caitanya. You are the deliverer of the fallen souls. You do not tolerate any statement which is against the teachings of devotional service enunciated by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

Śrīla Gaurakiśora Praṇati

**namo gaura-kiśorāya sākṣād-vairāgya-mūrtaye
vipralambha-rasāmbhodhe pādāmbujāya te namaḥ**

I offer my respectful obeisances unto Śrīla Gaurakiśora dāsa Bābājī Mahārāja [the spiritual master of Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī], who is renunciation personified. He is always merged in a feeling of separation and intense love of Kṛṣṇa.

Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Praṇati

**namo bhaktivinodāya sac-cid-ānanda-nāmine
gaura-śakti-svarūpāya rūpānuga-varāya te**

I offer my respectful obeisances unto Śrīla Saccidānanda

Bhaktivinoda, who is the transcendental energy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He is a strict follower of the Gosvāmīs, headed by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

Śrīla Jagannātha Praṇāti

gaurāvirbhāva-bhūmes tvaṁ nirdeṣṭā saj-jana-priyaḥ
vaiṣṇava-sārvabhaumaḥ śrī-jagannāthāya te namaḥ

I offer my respectful obeisances to Śrīla Jagannātha dāsa Bābājī, who is respected by the entire Vaiṣṇava community and who confirmed the discovery of the place where Lord Caitanya appeared.

Śrī Vaiṣṇava Praṇāma

vāñchā-kalpatarubhyaś ca kṛpā-sindhubhya eva ca
patitānāṁ pāvanebhyo vaiṣṇavebhyo namo namaḥ

I offer my respectful obeisances unto all the Vaiṣṇava devotees of the Lord. They are just like desire trees who can fulfill the desires of everyone, and they are full of compassion for the fallen conditioned souls.

Śrī Gaurāṅga Praṇāma

namo mahā-vadānyāya kṛṣṇa-prema-pradāya te
kṛṣṇāya kṛṣṇa-caitanya-nāmne gaura-tviṣe namaḥ

O most munificent incarnation! You are Kṛṣṇa Himself appearing as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu. You have assumed the golden color of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, and You are widely distributing pure love of Kṛṣṇa. We offer our respectful obeisances unto You.

Pañca-tattva Mahā-mantra

(jaya) śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda
śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

I offer my obeisances to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, Prabhu Nityānanda, Śrī Advaita, Gadādhara, Śrīvāsa and all others in the line of devotion.

Śrī Pañca-tattva Praṇāma

pañca-tattvātmakam kṛṣṇam bhakta-rūpa-svarūpakam
bhaktāvatāram bhaktākhyam namāmi bhakta-śaktikam

I offer my obeisances unto the Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa, who is non-different from His features as a devotee, devotional manifestation, devotional incarnation, pure devotee and devotional energy.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa Praṇāma

he kṛṣṇa karuṇā-sindho dīna-bandho jagat-pate
gopeśa gopikā-kānta rādhā-kānta namo 'stu te

O my dear Kṛṣṇa, O ocean of mercy, O friend of the distressed and the source of creation, O master of the cowherd men and the lover of the gopīs, especially Rādhārāṇī, I offer my respectful obeisances unto You.

Śrī Rādhā Praṇāma

tapta-kāñcana-gaurāṅgi rādhe vṛndāvaneśvari
vṛṣabhānu-sute devi praṇamāmi hari-priye

I offer my respectful obeisances to Śrīmātī Rādhārāṇī, whose bodily complexion is like molten gold and who is the Queen of Vṛndāvana. You are the daughter of King Vṛṣabhānu, and You are very dear to Lord Kṛṣṇa.

Hare Kṛṣṇa Mahā-mantra

Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa
Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare
Hare Rāma Hare Rāma
Rāma Rāma Hare Hare

O Śrīmāti Rādhārāṇī (the divine energy of Lord Kṛṣṇa), O all-attractive reservoir of pleasure, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, please engage me in Your loving devotional service.

PURPORT

by His Divine Grace

A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada

The transcendental vibration established by the chanting of Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare is the sublime method of reviving our Kṛṣṇa consciousness. As living spiritual souls we are all originally Kṛṣṇa conscious entities, but due to our association with matter from time immemorial, our consciousness is now polluted by the material atmosphere. The material atmosphere, in which we are now living, is called *māyā*, or illusion. *Māyā* means “that which is not.” And what is this illusion? The illusion is that we are all trying to be lords of material nature, while actually we are under the grip of her stringent laws. When a servant artificially tries to imitate the all-powerful master, this is called illusion. In this polluted concept of life, we are all trying to exploit the resources of material nature, but actually we are becoming

more and more entangled in her complexities. Therefore, although we are engaged in a hard struggle to conquer nature, we are ever more dependent on her. This illusory struggle against material nature can be stopped at once by revival of our Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

Kṛṣṇa consciousness is not an artificial imposition on the mind; this consciousness is the original energy of the living entity. When we hear the transcendental vibration, this consciousness is revived. And this process is recommended for this age by authorities. By practical experience also, one can perceive that by chanting this *mahā-mantra*, or the Great Chanting for Deliverance, one can at once feel a transcendental ecstasy coming through from the spiritual stratum. And when one is factually on the plane of spiritual understanding - surpassing the stages of senses, mind, and intelligence - one is situated on the transcendental plane. This chanting of Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare is directly enacted from the spiritual platform, and thus this sound vibration surpasses all lower strata of consciousness - namely sensual, mental, and intellectual. There is no need, therefore, to understand the language of the *mantra*, nor is there any need for mental speculation or any intellectual adjustment for chanting this *mahā-mantra*. It springs automatically from the spiritual platform, and as such, anyone can take part in the chanting without any previous qualification, and dance in ecstasy.

We have seen this practically. Even a child can take part in the chanting, or even a dog can take part in it. Of course, for one who is too entangled in material life, it takes a little more time to come to the standard point, but even such a materially engrossed man is raised to the spiritual platform very quickly. When the *mantra* is chanted by a pure devotee of the Lord in love, it has the greatest efficacy on the

hearers, and as such, this chanting should be heard from the lips of a pure devotee of the Lord, so that immediate effects can be achieved. As far as possible, chanting from the lips of nondevotees should be avoided. Milk touched by the lips of a serpent has poisonous effects.

The word *Harā* is the form of addressing the energy of the Lord, and the words *Kṛṣṇa* and *Rāma* are forms of addressing the Lord Himself. Both *Kṛṣṇa* and *Rāma* mean “the supreme pleasure,” and *Harā* is the supreme pleasure energy of the Lord, changed to *Hare* in the vocative. The supreme pleasure energy of the Lord helps us to reach the Lord.

The material energy, called *māyā*, is also one of the multi-energies of the Lord. And we, the living entities, are also the energy - marginal energy - of the Lord. The living entities are described as superior to material energy. When the superior energy is in contact with the inferior energy, an incompatible situation arises; but when the superior marginal energy is in contact with the superior energy, called *Harā*, the living entity is established in his happy, normal condition.

These three words, namely *Hare*, *Kṛṣṇa*, and *Rāma*, are the transcendental seeds of the *mahā-mantra*. The chanting is a spiritual call for the Lord and His internal energy, *Harā*, to give protection to the conditioned soul. This chanting is exactly like the genuine cry of a child for its mother. Mother *Harā* helps the devotee achieve the grace of the supreme father, *Hari*, or *Kṛṣṇa*, and the Lord reveals Himself to the devotee who chants this *mantra* sincerely.

No other means of spiritual realization, therefore, is as effective in this age as chanting the *mahā-mantra*: *Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare.*

2. Arati Songs

*Songs in this section are
sung daily in ISKCON temples
around the world.*

Śrī Śrī Gurv-aṣṭaka

(Eight Prayers to the Guru)

by Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura

Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura, who appeared in the middle of the seventeenth century, is a great spiritual master in the Kṛṣṇa conscious chain of gurus and disciples. He says, “One who, with great care and attention, loudly recites this beautiful prayer to the spiritual master during the *brāhma-muhūrta* obtains direct service to Kṛṣṇa, the Lord of Vṛndāvana, at the time of his death.”

samsāra-dāvānala-lidha-loka-
trāṇāya kārūṇya-ghanāghanatvam
prāptasya kalyāṇa-guṇārṇavasya
vande guroḥ śrī-caraṇāravindam (1)

The spiritual master is receiving benediction from the ocean of mercy. Just as a cloud pours water on a forest fire to extinguish it, so the spiritual master delivers the materially afflicted world by extinguishing the blazing fire of material existence. I offer my respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of such a spiritual master, who is an ocean of auspicious qualities.

mahāprabhoḥ kīrtana-nṛtya-gīta-
vāditra-mādyan-manaso rasena
romāñca-kampāśru-taraṅga-bhājo
vande guroḥ śrī-caraṇāravindam (2)

Chanting the holy name, dancing in ecstasy, singing, and playing musical instruments, the spiritual master is always gladdened by the *saṅkīrtana* movement of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Because he is relishing the mellows of pure devotion within his mind, sometimes his bodily hairs stand on end, he feels quivering in his body, and tears flow from his eyes like waves. I offer my respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of such a spiritual master.

śrī-vigrahārādhana-nitya-nānā-
śṅgāra-tan-mandira-mārjanādaḥ
yuktasya bhaktāṁś ca niyuñjato 'pi
vande guroḥ śrī-caraṇāravindam (3)

The spiritual master is always engaged in the temple worship of Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. He also engages his disciples in such worship. They dress the Deities in beautiful clothes and ornaments, clean Their temple, and perform other similar worship of the Lord. I offer my respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of such a spiritual master.

catur-vidha-śrī-bhagavat-prasāda-
svādv-anna-tṛptān hari-bhakta-saṅghān
kṛtvaiḥ tṛptim bhajataḥ sadaiva
vande guroḥ śrī-caraṇāravindam (4)

The spiritual master is always offering Kṛṣṇa four kinds of delicious food [analyzed as that which is licked, chewed, drunk, and sucked]. When the spiritual master sees that the devotees are satisfied by eating

bhagavat-prasāda, he is satisfied. I offer my respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of such a spiritual master.

śrī-rādhikā-mādhavayor apāra-
mādhurya-lilā guṇa-rūpa-nāmnām
prati-kṣaṇāsvādana-lolupasya
vande guroḥ śrī-caraṇāravindam (5)

The spiritual master is always eager to hear and chant about the unlimited conjugal pastimes of Śrī Śrī Rādhikā and Mādhava, and about Their qualities, names, and forms. The spiritual master aspires to relish these at every moment. I offer my respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of such a spiritual master.

nikuñja-yūno rati-keli-siddhyai
yā yālibhir yuktir apekṣaṇīyā
tatrāti-dākṣyād ati-vallabhasya
vande guroḥ śrī-caraṇāravindam (6)

The spiritual master is very dear, because he is expert in assisting the gopīs, who at different times make different tasteful arrangements for the perfection of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa's conjugal loving affairs within the groves of Vṛndāvana. I offer my most humble obeisances unto the lotus feet of such a spiritual master.

sākṣād-dharitvena samasta-śāstrair
uktas tathā bhāvyata eva sadbhīḥ
kintu prabhor yaḥ priya eva tasya
vande guroḥ śrī-caraṇāravindam (7)

The spiritual master is to be honored as much as the Supreme Lord because he is the most confidential servitor of the Lord. This is acknowledged in all revealed scriptures and followed by all authorities.

Therefore I offer my respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of such a spiritual master, who is a bona fide representative of Śrī Hari [Kṛṣṇa].

yasya prasādād bhagavat-prasādo
yasyāprasādān na gatiḥ kuto 'pi
dhyāyan stuvaṁs tasya yaśas tri-sandhyam
vande guroḥ śrī-caraṇāravindam (8)

By the mercy of the spiritual master one receives the benediction of Kṛṣṇa. Without the grace of the spiritual master, one cannot make any advancement. Therefore, I should always remember and praise the spiritual master. At least three times a day I should offer my respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of my spiritual master.

Śrī Narasimha Praṇāma

namas te narasimhāya prahlādāhlāda-dāyine
hiraṇyakaśipuṣ vakṣaḥ-śilā-ṭaṅka-nakhālaye

I offer my obeisances to Lord Narasimha who gives joy to Prahlāda Mahārāja and whose nails are like chisels on the stonelike chest of the demon Hiraṇyakaśipu.

ito nṛsimhaḥ parato nṛsimhaḥ
yato yato yāmi tato nṛsimhaḥ
bahir nṛsimhaḥ hṛdaye nṛsimhaḥ
nṛsimham ādim śaraṇam prapadye

Lord Nṛsimha is here and also there. Wherever I go Lord Nṛsimha is there. He is in the heart and is outside as well. I surrender to Lord Nṛsimha, the origin of all things and the supreme refuge.

Prayers to Lord Narasimha

1. Sung by Lord Caitanya before Lord Narasimha at Simhācala
(Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Madhya-līlā, 8.5)

śrī-nṛsimha, jaya nṛsimha, jaya jaya nṛsimha
prahlādeśa jaya padmā-mukha-padma-bhṛṅga

All glories to Nṛsimhadeva! All glories to Nṛsimhadeva, who is the Lord of Prahlāda Mahārāja and, like a honeybee, is always engaged in beholding the lotuslike face of the goddess of fortune.

2. From Śrī Daśāvatāra-stotra by Śrīla Jayadeva Gosvāmī

tava kara-kamala-vare nakham adbhuta-śṛṅgam
dalita-hiraṇyakaśipu-tanu-bhṛṅgam
keśava dhṛta-narahari-rūpa jaya jagadīśa hare

O Keśava! O Lord of the universe! O Lord Hari, who have assumed the form of a half-man, half-lion! All glories to You! With the wonderfully sharp nails on Your beautiful lotus hands You have ripped apart the wasplike body of Hiraṇyakaśipu.

Śrī Tulasī Praṇāma

In the morning, after *maṅgala-āratī* (and preferably also in the evening, before *sandhyā-āratī*), all the assembled devotees should attend tulasī worship and circumambulate Śrīmatī Tulasī-devī. First we offer obeisances to Tulasī-devī with the *tulasī-praṇāma-mantra*, chanted three times:

(om) vṛndāyai tulasī-devyai priyāyai keśavasya ca
viṣṇu-bhakti-prade devi satyavatyai namo namaḥ

I offer my repeated obeisances unto Vṛndā, Śrīmatī Tulasī-devī, who is very dear to Lord Keśava. O goddess, you bestow devotional service to Kṛṣṇa and you possess the highest truth.

Śrī Tulasī Kīrtana

namo namaḥ tulasī kṛṣṇa-preyasi namo namaḥ
rādhā-kṛṣṇa-sevā pābo ei abhilāṣī (1)

O Tulasī, beloved of Kṛṣṇa, I bow before you again and again. My desire is to obtain the service of Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

ye tomāra śaraṇa loy, tara vāñchā pūrṇa hoy
kṛpā kori' koro tāre vṛndāvana-vāsi (2)

Whoever takes shelter of you has his wishes fulfilled. Bestowing your mercy on him, you make him a resident of Vṛndāvana.

mora ei abhilāṣa, vilāsa kuñje dio vāsa
nayane heribo sadā yugala-rūpa-rāśi (3)

My desire is that you will also give me a residence in the pleasure groves of Śrī Vṛndāvana-dhāma. Thus within my vision I will always behold the beautiful pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

ei nivedana dharo, sakhīr anugata koro
sevā-adhikāra diye koro nīja dāsī (4)

I beg you to make me a follower of the cowherd damsels of Vraja. Please give me the privilege of devotional service and make me your own maidservant.

dīna kṛṣṇa-dāse koy, ei jena mora hoy
śrī-rādhā-govinda-preme sadā yena bhāsi (5)

This very fallen and lowly servant of Kṛṣṇa prays, “May I always swim in the love of Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Govinda.”

Śrī Tulasī Pradakṣiṇa Mantra

When the song is finished, the assembled Vaiṣṇavas should circumambulate Tulasī-devī at least four times and offer her water by pouring some drops at her root (only during morning worship, not in the evening). While circumambulating, we chant,

yāni kāni ca pāpāni brahma-hatyādikāni ca
tāni tāni praṇaśyanti pradakṣiṇaḥ pade pade

When a person circumambulates Śrīmatī Tulasī-devī, all the sins he may have committed are destroyed at every step, even the sin of killing a *brāhmaṇa*.

Darśana Ārati

(from Śrī Brahma-saṁhitā)

veṇuṁ kvaṇantam aravinda-dalāyatākṣaṁ
barhāvataṁsam asitāmbuda-sundarāṅgam
kandarpa-koṭi-kaminīya-viśeṣa-śobhaṁ
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, who is adept in playing on His flute, with blooming eyes like lotus petals with head decked with peacock's feather, with the figure of beauty tinged with the hue of blue clouds, and His unique loveliness charming millions of Cupids. [*Brahma-saṁhitā* Text 5.30]

aṅgāni yasya sakalendriya-vṛtti-manti
paśyanti pānti kalayanti ciraṁ jaganti
ānanda-cinmaya-sad-ujjvala-vigrahasya
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, whose transcendental form is full of bliss, truth, substantiality and is thus full of the most dazzling splendor. Each of the limbs of that transcendental figure possesses in Himself, the full-fledged functions of all the organs, and eternally sees, maintains and manifests the infinite universes, both spiritual and mundane. [*Brahma-saṁhitā* Text 5.32]

Sāvaraṇa-śrī-gaura-pāda-padme

(A Prayer to the Lotus Feet of Śrī Gaurāṅga)

from Prārthanā by Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu doyā koro more
tomā binā ke doyālu jagat-saṁsāre (1)

My dear Lord Caitanya, please be merciful to me, because who can be more merciful than Your Lordship within these three worlds?

**patita-pāvana-hetu tava avatāra
mo sama patita prabhu nā pāibe āra (2)**

Your incarnation is just to reclaim the conditioned, fallen souls, but I assure You that You will not find a greater fallen soul than me. Therefore, my claim is first.

**hā hā prabhu nityānanda, premānanda sukhi
kṛpāvalokana koro āmi boro duḥkhi (3)**

My dear Lord Nityānanda, You are always joyful in spiritual bliss. Since You always appear very happy, I have come to You because I am most unhappy. If You kindly put Your glance over me, then I may also become happy.

**doyā koro sītā-pati adwaita gosāi
tava kṛpā-bale pāi caitanya-nitāi (4)**

My dear Advaita Prabhu, husband of Sītā, You are so kind. Please be merciful to me. If You are kind to me, naturally Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda will also be kind to me.

**hā hā swarūp, sanātana, rūpa, raghunātha
bhaṭṭa-juga, śrī-jīva hā prabhu lokanātha (5)**

O Svarūpa Dāmodara, personal secretary of Lord Caitanya, O six Gosvāmīs; Śrī Rupa Gosvāmī, Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī, Śrī Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī, and Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī! O Lokanātha Gosvāmī, my beloved spiritual master! Narottama dāsa also prays for your mercy.

**doyā koro śrī-ācārya prabhu śrīnivāsa
rāmacandra-saṅga māge narottama-dāsa (6)**

O Śrīnivāsa Ācārya, successor to the six Gosvāmīs! Please be merciful to me. Narottama dāsa always desires the company of Rāmacandra Cakravartī.

Purport

by His Divine Grace

A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupāda

This is a song composed by Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura. He prays to Lord Caitanya, “My dear Lord, please be merciful to me, because who can be more merciful than Your Lordship within these three worlds?” Actually, this is a fact. Not only Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura, but Rūpa Gosvāmī also prayed to Lord Caitanya in this way. At the time of the first meeting of Lord Caitanya and Rūpa Gosvāmī at Prayāga (Allahabad), Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī said, “My dear Lord, You are the most munificent of all incarnations, because You are distributing love of Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa consciousness. “ When Kṛṣṇa was personally present He simply asked us to surrender, but He did not distribute Himself so easily. He made conditions - “First of all you surrender.” But this incarnation, Lord Caitanya, although Kṛṣṇa Himself, makes no such condition. He simply distributes: “Take love of Kṛṣṇa.” Therefore Lord Caitanya is approved as the most munificent incarnation. Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura says, “Please be merciful to me. You are so magnanimous, because You have seen the fallen souls of this age, and You are very much compassionate to them, but You should know also that I am the most fallen. No one is more greatly fallen than me.” *Patita-pāvana-hetu tava avatāra*: “Your incarnation is just to reclaim the conditioned, fallen souls, but I assure You that You will not find a greater fallen soul than me. Therefore, my claim is first.”

Then he prays to Lord Nityānanda. He says, *hā hā prabhu nityānanda premānanda-sukhī*: “My dear Lord Nityānanda, You are always joyful in spiritual bliss. Since You always appear very happy, I have come to You because I am most unhappy. If You kindly put Your glance over me, I may also become happy.” Then he prays to Advaita Prabhu. *Doyā koro sītā-pati advaita gosāi*. Advaita Prabhu’s wife’s name was Sītā. Therefore He is sometimes addressed as sītā-pati. Thus Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura prays, “My dear Advaita Prabhu, husband of Sītā, You are so kind. Please be kind to me. If You are kind to me, naturally Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda will also be kind to me.” Actually, Advaita Prabhu invited Lord Caitanya to come down. When Advaita Prabhu saw that the fallen souls were all engaged simply in sense gratificatory processes, not understanding Kṛṣṇa consciousness, He felt very much compassionate toward the fallen souls, and He also felt Himself incapable of claiming them all. He therefore prayed to Lord Kṛṣṇa, “Please come Yourself. Without Your personal presence it is not possible to deliver these fallen souls.” Thus by His invitation Lord Caitanya appeared. Naturally, Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura prays to Advaita Prabhu, “If You will be kind to me, naturally Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda also will be kind to me.”

Then he prays to the Gosvāmīs. *Hā hā swarūp, sanātana, rūpa, raghunātha*. Swarūp refers to Svarūpa Dāmodara, the personal secretary of Lord Caitanya. He was always with Caitanya Mahāprabhu and immediately arranged for whatever Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted. Two personal attendants, Svarūpa Dāmodara and Govinda, were always constantly with Lord Caitanya. Therefore, Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura also prays to Svarūpa Dāmodara and then to the six Gosvāmīs, the next disciples of Lord Caitanya - Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī,

Śrī Bhaṭṭa Raghunātha Gosvāmī, Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī, and Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. These six *Gosvāmīs* were directly instructed by Lord Caitanya to spread this movement of Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Narottama dāsa Thākura also prays for their mercy.

After the six *Gosvāmīs*, the next *ācārya* was Śrīnivāsa Ācārya. Actually, Narottama dāsa Thākura was in the disciplic succession after Śrīnivāsa Ācārya and was almost his contemporary, and Narottama dāsa's personal friend was Rāmacandra Cakravartī. Therefore he prays, "I always desire the company of Rāmacandra." He desires a devotee's company. The whole process is that we should always pray for the mercy of the superior *ācāryas* and keep company with pure devotees. Then it will be easier for us to advance in Kṛṣṇa consciousness and receive the mercy of Lord Caitanya and Lord Kṛṣṇa. This is the sum and substance of this song sung by Narottama dāsa Thākura.

Śrī Nāma-kīrtana

(Chanting of the Holy Names)

from Gītāvalī by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura

yaśomatī-nandana, braja-baro-nāgara,
gokula-rañjana kāna
gopī-parāṇa-dhana, madana-manohara,
kāliya-damana-vidhāna (1)

Lord Kṛṣṇa is the beloved son of mother Yaśodā; the transcendental lover in the land of Vraja; the delight of Gokula; Kāna [a nickname of Kṛṣṇa]; the wealth of the lives of the gopīs. He steals the mind of even Cupid and punishes the Kāliya serpent.

amala harinām amiya-vilāsā
vipina-purandara, navīna nāgara-bora,
baṁśī-badana suvāsā (2)

These pure, holy names of Lord Hari are full of sweet, nectarean pastimes. Kṛṣṇa is the Lord of the twelve forests of Vraja, He is ever-youthful and is the best of lovers. He is always playing on a flute, and He is an excellent dresser.

braja-jana-pālana, asura-kula-nāśana
nanda-godhana-rākhawālā
govinda mādhaba, navanīta-taskara,
sundara nanda-gopālā (3)

Kṛṣṇa is the protector of the inhabitants of Vraja; the destroyer of various demoniac dynasties; the keeper and tender of Nanda Mahārāja's cows; the giver of pleasure to the cows, land, and spiritual senses; the husband of the goddess of fortune; the butter thief; and the beautiful cowherd boy of Nanda Mahārāja.

yāmuna-taṭa-cara, gopī-basana-hara,
rāsa-rasika, kṛpāmoya
śrī-rādhā-vallabha, bṛndābana-naṭabara,
bhaktivinod-āśraya (4)

Kṛṣṇa wanders along the banks of the river Yamunā. He stole the garments of the young damsels of Vraja who were bathing there. He delights in the mellows of the *rāsa* dance; He is very merciful; the lover and beloved of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; the great dancer of Vṛndāvana; and the shelter and only refuge of Ṭhākura Bhaktivinoda.

Śrī Guru-vandanā

(The Worship of Śrī Guru)

from Prema-bhakti-candrikā by Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura

śrī-guru-caraṇa-padma, kevala-bhakati-sadma,
bando mui sāvadhāna mate
jāhāra prasāde bhāi, e bhava toriyā jāi,
kṛṣṇa-prāpti hoy jāhā ha'te (1)

The lotus feet of our spiritual master are the abode of pure devotional service. I bow down to his lotus feet with great care and attention. My dear brothers! It is through the grace of our spiritual master that we can cross over this material existence and attain Kṛṣṇa.

guru-mukha-padma-vākya, cittete koriyā aikya,
ār nā koriho mane āśā
śrī-guru-caraṇe rati, ei se uttama-gati,
je prasāde pūre sarva āśā (2)

Make the teachings emanating from the lotus mouth of our spiritual master one with your heart, and do not desire anything else. Attachment to his lotus feet is the best way to make spiritual advancement. His mercy fulfills all desires for spiritual perfection.

cakhu-dān dilo jei, janme janme prabhu sei,
divya jñān hṛde prokāśito
prema-bhakti jāhā hoite, avidyā vināśa jāte,
vede gāy jāhāra carito (3)

He who has given us the gift of transcendental vision is our lord, birth after birth. It is by his mercy that divine knowledge is revealed within our hearts, bestowing pure love for Kṛṣṇa and destroying ignorance. The Vedic scriptures sing of his character.

śrī-guru karuṇā-sindhu, adhama janāra bandhu,
lokanāth lokera jīvana
hā hā prabhu koro doyā, deho more pada-chāyā,
ebe jaśa ghuṣuk tribhuvana (4)

O spiritual master, O ocean of mercy and friend of the fallen! O universal teacher and life of all people! Be merciful unto us, O master, and give us the shade of your lotus feet. May your glories now be proclaimed throughout the three worlds.

Jaya Rādhā-Mādhava

(from *Gītāvalī* by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura)

(jaya) rādhā-mādhava (jaya) kuñja-bihārī
(jaya) gopī-jana-vallabha (jaya) giri-vara-dhārī
(jaya) jaśodā-nandana, (jaya) braja-jana-rañjana,
(jaya) jāmuna-tīra-vana-cārī

Kṛṣṇa is the lover of Rādhā. He displays many amorous pastimes in the groves of Vṛndāvana, He is the lover of the cowherd maidens of Vraja, the holder of the great hill named Govardhana, and the beloved son of mother Yaśodā. He delights the inhabitants of Vraja and wanders in the forests along the banks of the river Yamunā.

Gaura Ārati

(from *Gītāvalī* by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura)

jaya jaya gorācānder āratiko śobhā
jāhnavī-taṭa-vane jaga-mana-lobhā (1)

All glories, all glories to the beautiful *ārati* ceremony of Lord Caitanya! This *Gaura-ārati* is being performed in a grove on the bank of the Ganges and is captivating everyone in the universe.

dakṣiṇe nitāicānd, bāme gadādhara
nikaṭe adwaita, śrīnivāsa chatra-dhara (2)

On Lord Caitanya's right is Lord Nityānanda, and on His left is Śrī Gadādhara. Nearby stands Śrī Advaita, and Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura holds an umbrella over Lord Caitanya's head.

bosiyāche gorācānd ratna-simhāsane
ārati koren brahmā-ādi deva-gaṇe (3)

Lord Caitanya has sat down on a jeweled throne, and Lord Brahmā and the other demigods are performing His *ārati*.

narahari-ādi kori' cāmara ḍhulāya
sañjaya-mukunda-bāsu-ghoṣ-ādi gāya (4)

As Narahari Sarakāra and other associates of Lord Caitanya fan Him with *cāmaras*, Sañjaya Paṇḍita, Mukunda Datta, Vāsu Ghoṣa and other devotees sing sweet *kīrtana*.

śaṅkha bāje ghaṇṭā bāje bāje karatāla
madhura mṛdaṅga bāje parama rasāla (5)

Conchshells, bells, and *karatālas* resound, and the *mṛdaṅgas* play very sweetly. This *kīrtana* music is supremely sweet and relishable to hear.

**bahu-koṭi candra jini' vadana ujjvala
gala-deśe bana-mālā kore jhalamala (6)**

The brilliance of Lord Caitanya's face conquers millions upon millions of moons, and the garland of forest flowers around His neck shines.

**śiva-śuka-nārada preme gada-gada
bhakativinoda dekhe gorāra sampada (7)**

Lord Śiva, Śukadeva Gosvāmī, and Nārada Muni are all present, and their voices are choked with the great ecstasy of transcendental love. Thus Ṭhākura Bhaktivinoda envisions the glory of Lord Śrī Caitanya.

Sakhī-vṛnde Vijñapti

(Prayer to the Sakhīs)

from Prārthanā by Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura

**rādhā-kṛṣṇa prāṇa mora jugala-kiśora
jīvane maraṇe gati āro nāhi mora (1)**

The divine couple, Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, are my life and soul. In life or death I have no other refuge but Them.

**kālindīra kūle keli-kadambēra vana
ratana-bedīra upara bosābo du'jana (2)**

In a forest of small *kadamba* trees on the bank of the Yamunā, I will seat the divine couple on a throne made of brilliant jewels.

**śyāma-gaurī-aṅge dibo (cūwā) candanera gandha
cāmara ḍhulābo kabe heri mukha-candra (3)**

I will anoint Their dark and fair forms with sandalwood paste scented with *cūyā*, and I will fan Them with a *cāmara* whisk. Oh, when will I behold Their moonlike faces?

**gāthiyā mālatīr mālā dibo dohāra gale
adhare tuliyā dibo karpūra-tāmbūle (4)**

After stringing together garlands of *mālatī* flowers I will place them around Their necks, and I will offer *tāmbūla* scented with camphor to Their lotus mouths.

**lalitā viśākhā-ādi jata sakhī-bṛnda
ājñāya koribo sebā caraṇāravinda (5)**

With the permission of all the *sakhīs*, headed by Lalitā and Viśākhā, I will serve the lotus feet of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

**śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-prabhur dāser anudāsa
sevā abhilāṣa kore narottama-dāsa (6)**

Narottama dāsa, the servant of the servant of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Prabhu, longs for this service to the divine couple.

3. Other Vaiṣṇava Songs

Aruṇodaya Kīrtana

(Kīrtana songs to be sung at dawn)

from *Gītāvalī* by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura

1. Udilo Aruṇa

udilo aruṇa pūraba-bhāge,
dwija-maṇi gorā amani jāge,
bhakata-samūha loiyā sāthe,
gelā nagara-brāje (1)

When the eastern horizon became tinged with the redness that heralds the rising of the sun, the jewel among the twice-born *brāhmaṇas*, Lord Gaurasundara, immediately awakened. Taking all His devotees with Him, He journeyed through the towns and villages of Nadiyā.

‘tāthai tāthai’ bājalo khol,
ghana ghana tāhe jhānjera rol,
preme dhala dhala soṇāra aṅga,
caraṇe nūpara bāje (2)

The *mṛdaṅgas* resounded “tāthai, tāthai” in quick succession while the large *jhānjha* cymbals chimed in time. Lord Gaurāṅga’s golden form trembles again and again in ecstatic love of Godhead, and His footbells jingle.

mukunda mādharma yādava hari,
bolena bolo re vadana bhoṛi’,
miche nida-bāse gelo re rāti,
divasa śarīra-sāje (3)

Lord Caitanya calls out to the townsfolk, “Fill your mouths with the holy names `Mukunda! Mādhava! Yādava! and Hari!’ You spend your nights uselessly sleeping and your days decorating your bodies!”

emana durlabha mānava-deho,
pāiyā ki koro bhāva nā keho,
ebe nā bhajile yaśodā-suta,
carama poḍibe lāje (4)

“You have achieved this rare human body. Don’t you care for this gift? If you do not worship the darling of Mother Yaśodā now, then great sorrow awaits you at the time of your death.”

udita tapana hoile asta,
dina gelo boli’ hoibe byasta,
tabe keno ebe alasa hoy,
nā bhaja hṛdoya-rāje (5)

“With every rising and setting of the sun, a day passes and is lost. Why then do you remain idle and not serve the Lord of the heart?”

jīvana anitya jānaha sār,
tāhe nānā-vidha vipada-bhār,
nāmāśraya kori’ jatane tumi,
thākaha āpana kāje (6)

“You should understand this essential fact: Life is temporary and filled with various kinds of misery. Therefore, carefully take shelter of the holy name and remain always engaged in His service as your eternal occupation.”

jīvera kalyāna-sādhana-kām,
jagate āśi’ e madhura nām,
avidyā-timira-tapana-rūpe,
hṛd-gagaṇe virāje (7)

“Desiring to shower benedictions upon all living entities, this sweet name of Kṛṣṇa has descended to this material universe and shines like the sun in the sky of the heart, destroying the darkness of ignorance.”

kṛṣṇa-nāma-sudhā koriyā pān,
jurāo bhakativinoda-prān,
nāma vinā kichu nāhiko āro,
caudda-bhuvana-mājhe (8)

Drink the pure nectar of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa and thus satisfy the soul of Bhaktivinoda. Except for the holy name there is nothing within all the fourteen worlds.

2. Jīva jāgo

jīva jāgo, jīva jāgo, gauracānda bole
kota nidrā jāo mājhe-pīṣācīra kole (1)

“Wake up, sleeping souls! Wake up, sleeping souls!” Lord Gaurāṅga calls, “You have slept so long in the lap of the witch Māyā!”

bhājibō boliyā ese soṁsāra-bhitare
bhuliyā rohile tumi avidyāra bhare (2)

“You came into this world saying, ‘O my Lord I will certainly worship You,’ but having forgotten this promise you remain in great ignorance.”

tomāre loite āmi hoinu avatāra
āmi vinā bandhu āra ke āche tomāra (3)

“I have descended to this world just to reclaim you. Other than Myself, who else is your true friend?”

enechi auṣadhi mājhe nāśibāro lāgi’
hari-nāma mahā-mantra lao tumi māgi’ (4)

“I have brought the medicine for destroying the illusion of *Māyā*. Now beg for this *hari-nāma-mahā-mantra* and take it.”

**bhaktivinoda prabhu-caraṇe pariyā
sei hari-nāma-mantra loilo māgiyā (5)**

Bhaktivinoda fell at the lotus feet of Lord Gaurāṅga, and after begging for the holy name he indeed received that *mahā-mantra*.

Vibhāvarī Śeṣa

(from *Kalyāṇa-kalpataru* by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura)

**vibhāvarī śeṣa, āloka-praveśa,
nidrā chāri’ uṭho jīva
bolo hari hari, mukunda murāri,
rāma kṛṣṇa hayagrīva (1)**

The night has come to an end and the light of dawn is entering. O *jīva* soul, arise and give up your sleep. Chant the holy names of Lord Hari, who is the giver of liberation; the enemy of the Mura demon; the supreme enjoyer; the all-attractive one; and the horse-headed incarnation, Hayagrīva.

**nṛsimha vāmana, śrī-madhusūdana,
brajendra-nandana śyāma
pūtanā-ghātana, kaiṭabha-śātana,
jaya dāśarathi-rāma (2)**

Lord Hari [Kṛṣṇa] incarnated as the half-man, half-lion, Nṛsimha. He appeared as a dwarf-*brāhmaṇa* named Upendra and is the killer of the Madhu demon. He is the beloved son of the King of Vraja, Nanda Mahārāja, and is dark in complexion. He is the slayer of the Pūtanā witch and the destroyer of the demon Kaiṭabha. All glories to Lord Hari, who appeared as Lord Rāma, the son of King Daśaratha.

yaśodā dulāla, govinda-gopāla,
vṛndāvana purandara
gopī-priya-jana, rādhikā-ramaṇa,
bhuvana-sundara-bara (3)

He is the darling of mother Yaśodā; the giver of pleasure to the cows, land, and spiritual senses; and the protector of the cows. He is the Lord of the Vṛndāvana forest; the gopīs' beloved; the lover of Rādhikā; and the most beautiful personality in all the worlds.

rāvāṇāntakara, mākhana-taskara,
gopī-jana-vastra-hārī
brajera rākhāla, gopa-vṛnda-pāla,
citta-hārī baṁśī-dhārī (4)

As Rāmacandra He brought about the end of the demoniac King Rāvaṇa; as Kṛṣṇa He stole the older gopīs' butter; He stole the younger gopīs' clothes while they were bathing in the Yamunā. He is a cowherd boy of Vraja and the protector of the cowherd boys. He steals the hearts of all and always holds a flute.

yogīndra-bandana, śrī-nanda-nandana,
braja-jana-bhaya-hārī
navīna nīrada, rūpa manohara,
mohana-baṁśī-bihārī (5)

Lord Kṛṣṇa is worshiped by the best of yogīs and is the son of Nanda. He removes all the fears of the inhabitants of Vraja. He is the color of a fresh rain cloud, and His form is enchanting. When He wanders about, playing His flute, He looks very charming.

yaśodā-nandana, kaṁsa-nisūdana,
nikuñja-rāsa-vilāsī
kadamba-kānana, rāsa-parāyaṇa,
bṛnda-vipina-nivāsī (6)

He is the son of Yaśodā and the killer of King Kāmsa, and He sports in the *rāsa* dance among the groves of Vraja. Kṛṣṇa engages in this *rāsa* dance underneath the *kadamba* trees, and He resides in the forest of Vṛndāvana.

ānanda-vardhana, prema-niketana,
phula-śara-jojaka kāma
gopāṅganā-gaṇa, citta-vinodana,
samasta-guṇa-gaṇa-dhāma (7)

He increases the ecstasy of His devotees. He is the reservoir of all love and is the transcendental Cupid who uses His flowered arrows to increase the loving desires of the gopīs. He is the pleasure of the gopīs' hearts and the abode of all wonderful qualities.

jāmuna-jīvana, keli-parāyaṇa,
mānasa-candra-cakora
nāma-sudhā-rasa, gāo kṛṣṇa-jaśa
rākho vacana mana mora (8)

Lord Kṛṣṇa is the life of the river Yamunā. He is always absorbed in amorous pastimes, and He is the moon of the gopīs' minds, which are like the *cakora* birds that subsist only upon moonlight. O mind, obey these words of mine and sing the glories of Śrī Kṛṣṇa in the form of these holy names, which are full of nectarean mellows.

Gurudeva

(from Śaraṇāgati by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura)

gurudev!

kṛpā-bindu diyā, koro' ei dāse,
tṛṇāpekḥā ati hīna
sakala saḥane, bala diyā koro',
nija-māne sprḥā-hīna (1)

O Gurudeva! By administering a drop of your mercy make this servant of yours infinitely more humble than a blade of grass. Giving me the strength to bear all trials and troubles, free me from desires for personal honor.

sakale sammāna, korite śakati,
deho' nātha! jathājatha
tabe to' gāibo, hari-nāma-sukhe,
aparādha ha'be hata (2)

O lord and master! Inspire me with the power to befittingly honor all living beings. Only then will I sing the holy name of the Lord in great ecstasy, and my offensive activities will cease.

kabe heno kṛpā, labhiyā e jana,
kṛtārtha hoibe, nātha!
śakti-buddhi-hīna, āmi ati dīna,
koro' more ātma-sātha (3)

When will this person be indeed blessed by receiving your mercy, O lord and master? Devoid of all strength and intelligence, I am very low and fallen. Please make me your own.

yogyatā-vicāre, kichu nāhi pāi,
tomāra karuṇā—sāra
karuṇā nā hoile, kāndiyā kāndiyā,
prāṇa nā rākhibo āra (4)

When I examine myself for worthiness, I find nothing of value. Therefore your mercy is the essence of life. If you are not merciful to me, then I will constantly weep and weep, no longer being able to maintain my life.

Ohe! Vaiṣṇava Ṭhākura

(from Śaraṇāgati by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura)

ohe!
vaiṣṇava ṭhākura, doyāra sāgara,
e dāse korunā kori'
diyā pada-chāyā, śodho he āmāya,
tomāra caraṇa dhori (1)

O revered Vaiṣṇava Ṭhākura! O ocean of mercy! Please be merciful to me, your humble servant. Purify me by giving the shade of your lotus feet. Your feet I clasp submissively.

chaya bega domi', chaya doṣa śodhi',
chaya guna deho' dāse
chaya sat-saṅga, deho' he āmāre,
boshechi saṅgera āse (2)

Please help me to control the six urges, purify me of the six faults, and please instill in your servant the six good qualities. Oh, bestow upon me the six kinds of holy association! I am seated here in the hope of having your company.

ekakī āmāra, nāhi pāya bala,
hari-nāma-saṅkīrtane
tumi kṛpā kori', śraddhā-bindu diyā,
deho' kṛṣṇa-nāma-dhane (3)

On my own, I find I have no strength to chant the holy name of Lord Hari. Please be merciful by awarding me with a particle of faith and giving me the great treasure of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa.

kṛṣṇa se tomāra, kṛṣṇa dite pāro,
tomāra śakati āche
āmi to' kāṅgāla, 'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' boli',
dhāi tava pāche pāche (4)

Kṛṣṇa is yours, therefore you are able to give Him to others. This is certainly within your power. I am indeed wretched and fallen, simply running after you crying “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!”

Nāma-saṅkīrtana

(by Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura)

hari haraye namaḥ kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ
yādavāya mādhavāya keśavāya namaḥ (1)

O Lord Hari, O Lord Kṛṣṇa, I offer my obeisances to You, who are known as Hari, Yādava, Mādhava, and Keśava.

gopāla govinda rāma śrī-madhusūdana
gīrīdhārī gopīnātha madana-mohana (2)

O Gopāla, Govinda, Rāma, Śrī Madhusūdana, Gīrīdhārī, Gopīnātha, and Madana-mohana!

śrī-caitanya-nityānanda śrī-advaita-sītā
hari guru vaiṣṇava bhāgavata gītā (3)

All glories to Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda! All glories to Śrī Advaita Ācārya and His consort, Śrī Sītā Ṭhākurāṇī. All glories to Lord Hari, to the spiritual master, the Vaiṣṇavas, Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, and Śrīmad Bhagavad-Gītā.

**śrī-rūpa sanātana bhaṭṭa-raghunātha
śrī-jīva gopāla-bhaṭṭa dāsa-raghunātha (4)**

All glories to Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, Sanātana Gosvāmī, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, and Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī.

**ei chay gosāir kori caraṇa vandan
jāhā hoite bighna-nās abhiṣṭa-pūraṇ (5)**

I offer my obeisances to the feet of these six Gosvāmīs. By bowing to them, all obstacles to devotion are destroyed and all spiritual desires are fulfilled.

**ei chay gosāi jār—mui tār dās
tā-sabāra pada-reṇu mora pañca-grās (6)**

I am the servant of that person who is a servant of these six Gosvāmīs. The dust of their lotus feet is my five kinds of foodstuffs.

**tādera caraṇa-sebi-bhakta-sane bās
janame janame hoy ei abhilāṣ (7)**

This is my desire: that birth after birth I may live with those devotees who serve the lotus feet of these six Gosvāmīs.

**ei chay gosāi jabe braje koilā bās
rādhā-kṛṣṇa-nitya-lilā korilā prakāś (8)**

When these six Gosvāmīs lived in Vraja they revealed the lost holy places and explained the eternal pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

ānande bolo hari bhaja bṛndāban
śrī-guru-vaiṣṇaba-pade majāiyā man (9)

Just chant the names of Lord Hari in great ecstasy and worship the transcendental realm of Vṛndāvana while absorbing your mind in meditation upon the divine feet of the spiritual master and the Vaiṣṇavas.

śrī-guru-vaiṣṇaba-pada-padma kori āś
narottama dāsa kohe nāma-saṅkīrtana (10)

Desiring to serve the lotus feet of Śrī Guru and the Vaiṣṇavas, Narottama dāsa sings this *saṅkīrtana* of the holy names of Lord Hari.

Bhajahū Re Mana Śrī Nanda-nandana

(by Govinda Dāsa Kavirāja)

bhajahū re mana śrī-nanda-nandana
abhaya-caraṇāravinda re
durlabha mānava-janama sat-saṅge
taroho e bhava-sindhu re (1)

O mind, just worship the lotus feet of the son of Nanda, which make one fearless. Having obtained this rare human birth, cross over this ocean of worldly existence through the association of saintly persons.

śīta ātapa bāta bariṣaṇa
e dina jāminī jāgi re
biphale sevinu kṛpaṇa durajana
capala sukha-laba lāgi' re (2)

Day and night I remain sleepless, suffering heat and cold, wind

and rain. For a bit of flickering happiness I have vainly served wicked and miserly men.

e dhana, yaubana, putra, parijana
ithe ki āche paratīti re
kamala-dala-jala, jīvana ṭalamala
bhajahū hari-pada nīti re (3)

What assurance of real happiness is there in all of one's wealth, youthfulness, sons, and family members? This life is tottering like a drop of water on a lotus petal; therefore you should always serve and worship the divine feet of Lord Hari.

śravaṇa, kīrtana, smaraṇa, vandana,
pāda-sevana, dāsyā re
pūjana, sakhi-jana, ātma-nivedana
govinda-dāsa-abhilāṣa re (4)

Govinda Dāsa longs to hear the glories of Lord Hari, chant His glories, constantly remember Him, offer Him prayers, serve His lotus feet, become His servant, worship Him, serve Him as a friend, and completely offer Him his very self.

Śrī Vraja-dhāma-mahimāmṛta
(The Nectarean Glories of Vraja-dhāma)
jaya rādhe, jaya kṛṣṇa, jaya vṛndāvan
śrī govinda, gopīnātha, madana-mohan (1)

All glories to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa and the divine forest of Vṛndāvana!
All glories to the three presiding Deities of Vṛndāvana - Śrī Govinda, Gopīnātha, and Madana-mohana!

śyama-kunḍa, rādhā-kunḍa, giri-govardhan

kālindī jamunā jaya, jaya mahāvan (2)

All glories to Śyāma-kunḍa and Rādhā-kunḍa, Govardhana Hill, and the Yamunā river (Kālindī)! All glories to the great forest known as Mahāvana, where Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma displayed Their childhood pastimes!

keśī-ghāṭa, vaṁśī-vaṭa, dwādaśa-kānan

jāhā saba līlā koilo śrī-nanda-nandan (3)

Glories to Keśī-ghāṭa, where Kṛṣṇa killed the Keśī demon! All glories to the Vaṁśī-vaṭa tree, to which Kṛṣṇa attracted all the gopīs by playing His flute! Glories to all twelve forests of Vraja! At these places the son of Nanda, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, performed His pastimes.

śrī-nanda-jaśodā jaya, jaya gopa-gaṇ

śrīdāmādi jaya, jaya dhenu-vatsa-gaṇ (4)

All glories to Kṛṣṇa's father and mother, Nanda and Yaśodā! All glories to the cowherd boys, headed by Śrīdāmā! All glories to the cows and calves of Vraja!

jaya bṛṣabhānu, jaya kīrtidā sundarī

jaya paurnamāsī, jaya ābhīra-nāgarī (5)

All glories to Rādhā's father and mother, Vṛṣabhānu and the beautiful Kīrtidā! All glories to Paurṇamāsī, the mother of Sāndīpani Muni, grandmother of Madhumāṅgala, and beloved disciple of Devarṣi Nārada! All glories to the young cowherd maidens of Vraja!

jaya jaya gopīśwara vṛndāvana-mājha

jaya jaya kṛṣṇa-sakhā baṭu dwija-rāj (6)

All glories, all glories to Gopīśwara Śiva, who resides in Vṛndāvana

to protect the holy *dhāma*! All glories, all glories to Kṛṣṇa's funny *brāhmaṇa* friend, Madhumaṅgala!

jaya rāma-ghāta, jaya rohiṇī-nandan
jaya jaya vṛndāvana-bāsī jata jan (7)

All glories to Rāma-ghāta, where Lord Balarāma performed His *rāsa* dance! All glories to Lord Balarāma, the son of Rohiṇī! All glories, all glories to all the residents of Vṛndāvana!

jaya dwija-patnī, jaya nāga-kanyā-gaṇ
bhaktite jāhārā pāilo govinda-caraṇ (8)

All glories to the wives of the proud Vedic *brāhmaṇas*! All glories to the wives of the Kāliya serpent! Through pure devotion they all obtained the lotus feet of Lord Govinda.

śrī-rāsa-maṇḍala jaya, jaya rādhā-śyām
jaya jaya rāsa-līlā sarva-manoram (9)

All glories to the place where Śrī Kṛṣṇa performed His *rāsa* dance! All glories to Rādhā and Śyām! All glories, all glories to the divine *rāsa* dance, the most beautiful of all Lord Kṛṣṇa's pastimes!

jaya jayojjwala-rasa sarva-rasa-sār
parakīyā-bhāve jāhā brajete pracār (10)

All glories, all glories to the mellow of conjugal love, which is the most excellent of all *rasas* and which Śrī Kṛṣṇa propagates in Vraja in the form of *parakīyā-bhāva* (paramour love)!

śrī-jāhnavā-pāda-padma koriyā smaraṇ
dīna kṛṣṇa-dāsa kohe nāma-saṅkīrtan (11)

Remembering the lotus feet of Lord Nityānanda's consort, Śrī

Jāhnavā Devī, this very fallen and lowly servant of Kṛṣṇa sings the *saṅkīrtana* of the holy name.

Śrī Dāmodarāṣṭaka

(found in the Padma Purāṇa of Kṛṣṇa Dvaipāyana Vyāsa, spoken by Satyavrata Muni in a conversation with Nārada Muni and Śaunaka Ṛṣi)

“In the month of Kārtika one should worship Lord Dāmodara and daily recite the prayer known as Dāmodarāṣṭaka, which has been spoken by the sage Satyavrata and which attracts Lord Dāmodara.”

(Śrī Hari-bhakti-vilāsa 2.16.198)

namāmīśvaraṁ sac-cid-ānanda-rūpaṁ
lasat-kuṇḍalaṁ gokule bhrājamānam
yaśodā-bhiyolūkhalād dhāvamānam
parāmṛṣṭam atyantato drutya gopyā (1)

To the Supreme Lord, whose form is the embodiment of eternal existence, knowledge, and bliss, whose shark-shaped earrings are swinging to and fro, who is beautifully shining in the divine realm of Gokula, who [due to the offense of breaking the pot of yogurt that His mother was churning into butter and then stealing the butter that was kept hanging from a swing] is quickly running from the wooden grinding mortar in fear of mother Yaśodā, but who has been caught from behind by her who ran after Him with greater speed—to that Supreme Lord, Śrī Dāmodara, I offer my humble obeisances.

rudantaṁ muhur netra-yugmaṁ mrjantaṁ
karāmbhoja-yugmena sātāṅka-netram
muhuh śvāsa-kampa-tirekhāṅka-kaṇṭha-
sthita-graivaṁ dāmodaraṁ bhakti-baddham (2)

[Seeing the whipping stick in His mother's hand,] He is crying and rubbing His eyes again and again with His two lotus hands. His eyes are filled with fear, and the necklace of pearls around His neck, which is marked with three lines like a conchshell, is shaking because of His quick breathing due to crying. To this Supreme Lord, Śrī Dāmodara, whose belly is bound not with ropes but with His mother's pure love, I offer my humble obeisances.

itīdr̥k sva-lilābhir ānanda-kunḍe
sva-ghoṣaṁ nimajjantam ākhyāpayantam
tadiyeṣita-jñeṣu bhaktair jitatvaṁ
punaḥ prematas taṁ śatāvṛtti vande (3)

By such childhood pastimes as this, He is drowning the inhabitants of Gokula in pools of ecstasy, and is revealing to those devotees who are absorbed in knowledge of His supreme majesty and opulence that He is only conquered by devotees whose pure love is imbued with intimacy and is free from all conceptions of awe and reverence. With great love, I again offer my obeisances to Lord Dāmodara hundreds and hundreds of times.

varam deva mokṣaṁ na mokṣāvadhiṁ vā
na cānyaṁ vṛṇe 'haṁ vareṣād apiha
idaṁ te vapur nātha gopāla-bālaṁ
sadā me manasy āvirāstāṁ kim anyaiḥ (4)

O Lord, although You are able to give all kinds of benedictions, I do not pray to You for the boon of impersonal liberation, nor the highest liberation of eternal life in Vaikuṇṭha, nor any other boon [which may be obtained by executing the nine processes of bhakti]. O Lord, I simply wish that this form of Yours as Bāla Gopāla in Vṛndāvana may

ever be manifest in my heart, for what is the use to me of any other boon besides this?

idaṁ te mukhāmbhojam atyanta-nīlair
vṛtaṁ kuntalaiḥ snigdha-raktaiś ca gopyā
muḥś cumbitaṁ bimba-raktādharaṁ me
manasy āvirāstāṁ alaṁ lakṣa-lābhaiḥ (5)

O Lord, Your lotus face, which is encircled by locks of soft black hair tinged with red, is kissed again and again by mother Yaśodā, and Your lips are reddish like the *bimba* fruit. May this beautiful vision of Your lotus face be ever manifest in my heart. Thousands and thousands of other benedictions are of no use to me.

namo deva dāmodarānanta viṣṇo
praśīda prabho duḥkha-jālābdhi-magṇam
kṛpā-dṛṣṭi-vṛṣṭyāti-dīnaṁ batānu
grhāṇeṣa mām ajñam edhy akṣi-dṛśyaḥ (6)

O Supreme Godhead, I offer my obeisances unto You. O Dāmodara! O Ananta! O Viṣṇu! O master! O my Lord, be pleased upon me. By showering Your glance of mercy upon me, deliver this poor ignorant fool who is immersed in an ocean of worldly sorrows, and become visible to my eyes.

kuverātmajau baddha-mūrtyaiva yadvat
tvayā mocitau bhakti-bhājau kṛtau ca
tathā prema-bhaktiṁ svakāṁ me prayaccha
na mokṣe graho me 'sti dāmodareha (7)

O Lord Dāmodara, just as the two sons of Kuvera—Maṇigrīva and Nalakūvara—were delivered from the curse of Nārada and made

into great devotees by You in Your form as a baby tied with rope to a wooden grinding mortar, in the same way, please give to me Your own *prema-bhakti*. I only long for this and have no desire for any kind of liberation.

namas te 'stu dāmne sphurad-dīpti-dhāmne
tvadīyodarāyātha viśvasya dhāmne
namo rādhikāyai tvadīya-priyāyai
namo 'nanta-līlāya devāya tubhyam (8)

O Lord Dāmodara, I first of all offer my obeisances to the brilliantly effulgent rope which binds Your belly. I then offer my obeisances to Your belly, which is the abode of the entire universe. I humbly bow down to Your most beloved Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, and I offer all obeisances to You, the Supreme Lord, who displays unlimited pastimes.

Śrī Rādhikā-stava

(from *Stava-mālā* by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī)

(chorus)

rādhe jaya jaya mādharma-dayite
gokula-taruṇī-maṇḍala-mahite

(chorus) O Rādhā! O beloved of Mādhava! O You who are worshiped by all the young girls of Gokula! All glories unto You! All glories unto You!

dāmodara-rati-varḍhana-veśe
hari-niṣkuṭa-vṛndā-vipineśe (1)

O You who dress Yourself in such a way as to increase Lord

Dāmodara's love and attachment for You! O Queen of Vṛndāvana, which is the pleasure grove of Lord Hari!

vṛṣabhānūdadhī-nava-śaśi-lekhe
lalitā-sakhi guṇa-ramita-viśākhē (2)

O new moon who has arisen from the ocean of King Vṛṣabhānu!
O friend of Lalitā! O You who make Viśākhā loyal to You due to
Your wonderful qualities of friendliness, kindness, and faithfulness
to Kṛṣṇa!

karuṇām kuru mayi karuṇā-bharite
sanaka-sanātana-varṇita-carite (3)

O You who are filled with compassion! O You whose divine
characteristics are described by the great sages Sanaka and Sanātana!
O Rādhā, please be merciful to me!

Sapārṣada-bhagavad-viraha-janita-vilāpa

(Lamentation due to separation from the Lord and His associates)
from Prārthanā by Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura

je ānilo prema-dhana koruṇā pricur
heno prabhu kothā gelā ācārya-ṭhākur (1)

He who brought the treasure of divine love and who was filled with compassion and mercy—where has such a personality as Śrīnivāsa Ācārya gone?

kāhā mora swarūp rūpa kāhā sanātan
kāhā dāsa raghunātha patita-pāvan (2)

Where are my Svarūpa Dāmodara and Rūpa Gosvāmī? Where is Sanātana? Where is Raghunātha dāsa, the savior of the fallen?

kāhā mora bhaṭṭa-juga kāhā kavirāj
eka-kāle kothā gelā gorā naṭa-rāj (3)

Where are my Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa and Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, and where is Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja? Where did Lord Gaurāṅga, the great dancer, suddenly go?

pāṣaṇe kuṭibo māthā anale paśibo
gaurāṅga guṇera nidhi kothā gele pābo (4)

I will smash my head against the rock and enter into the fire. Where will I find Lord Gaurāṅga, the reservoir of all wonderful qualities?

se-saba saṅgīra saṅge je koilo bilās
se-saṅga nā pāiyā kānde narottama dās (5)

Unable to obtain the association of Lord Gaurāṅga accompanied by all of these devotees in whose association He performed His pastimes, Narottama dāsa simply weeps.

4. Krishna Consciousness at Home

An Introduction

Living in the association of Krishna's devotees in a temple or *ashrama* makes it easier to practise devotional service. But if you're determined, you can follow at home the teachings of Krishna consciousness and thus convert your home into a temple.

Spiritual life, like material life, means practical activity. The difference is that whereas we perform material activities for the benefit of ourselves or those we consider ours, we perform spiritual activities for the benefit of Lord Krishna, under the guidance of the scriptures and the spiritual master. The key is to accept the guidance of the scripture and the *guru*. Krishna declares in the Bhagavad-gita that a person can achieve neither happiness nor the supreme destination of life — going Back to Godhead, back to Lord Krishna—if he or she does not follow the injunctions of the scriptures. And how to follow the scriptural rules by engaging in practical service to the Lord—that is explained by a bonafide spiritual master. Without following the instructions of a spiritual master who is in an authorized chain of disciplic succession coming from Krishna Himself, we cannot make spiritual progress. The practices outlined here are the timeless practices of *bhakti-yoga* as given by the foremost spiritual master and exponent of Krishna consciousness in our time, His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, founder-*acharya* of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON).

The purpose of spiritual knowledge is to bring us closer to God. Krishna says in the Bhagavad-gita (18.55), *bhaktyā mām abhijānāti*: “I can be known only by devotional service.” Knowledge guides us in proper action. Spiritual knowledge directs us to satisfy the desires of Krishna through practical engagements in His loving service. Without practical application, theoretical knowledge is of little value. Spiritual knowledge is meant to direct us in all aspects of life. We should endeavor, therefore, to organize our lives in such a way as to follow Krishna’s teachings as far as possible. We should try to do our best, to do more than is simply convenient. Then it will be possible for us to rise to the transcendental plane of Krishna consciousness, even while living far from a temple.

Chanting the Hare Krishna Mantra

The first principle in devotional service is to chant the Hare Krishna *mahā-mantra* (*mahā* means “great”; *mantra* means “sound that liberates the mind from ignorance”):

**Hare Krishna Hare Krishna Krishna Krishna Hare Hare
Hare Rama Hare Rama Rama Rama Hare Hare**

You can chant these holy names of the Lord anywhere and at any time, but it is best to set a specific time of the day to regularly chant. Early morning hours are ideal.

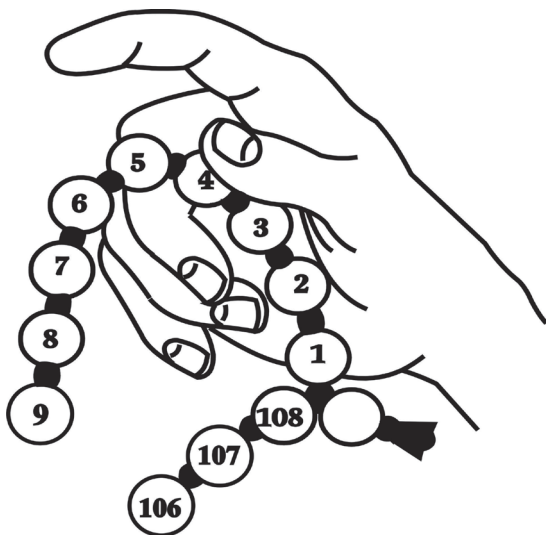
The chanting can be done in two ways: singing the *mantra*, called *kirtana* (usually done in a group), and saying the *mantra* to oneself, called *japa* (which literally means “to speak softly”). Concentrate on hearing the sound of the holy names. As you chant, pronounce the names clearly and distinctly, addressing Krishna in a prayerful mood.

When your mind wanders, bring it back to the sound of the Lord's names. Chanting is a prayer to Krishna that means "O energy of the Lord [Hare], O all-attractive Lord [Krishna], O Supreme Enjoyer [Rāma], please engage me in Your service." The more attentively and sincerely you chant these names of God, the more spiritual progress you will make.

Since God is all-powerful and all-merciful, He has kindly made it very easy for us to chant His names, and He has also invested all His powers in them. Therefore the names of God and God Himself are identical. This means that when we chant the holy names of Krishna and Rāma, we are directly associating with God and being purified. Therefore we should always try to chant with devotion and reverence. The Vedic literature states that Lord Krishna is personally dancing on your tongue when you chant His holy name.

When you chant alone, it is best to chant on *japa* beads (available at the ISKCON temple). This not only helps you fix your attention on the holy name, but it also helps you count the number of times you chant the *mantra* daily. Each strand of *japa* beads contains 108 small beads and one large bead, the head bead. Begin on a bead next to the head bead and gently hold it between the thumb and middle finger of your right hand as you chant the full Hare Krishna *mantra*. Then move to the next bead and repeat the process. In this way, chant on each of the 108 beads until you reach the head bead again. This is one round of *japa*. Then, without chanting on the head bead, reverse the beads and start your second round on the last bead you chanted on.

Initiated devotees vow before the spiritual master to chant at least sixteen rounds of the Hare Krishna *mantra* daily. But even if you can



chant only one round a day, the principle is that once you commit yourself to chanting that round, you should try and complete it every day without fail. When you feel you can chant more, then increase the minimum number of rounds you chant each day—but don't fall below that number. You can chant more than your fixed number, but you should maintain a set minimum each day. (Please note that the beads are sacred and therefore should never touch the ground or be put in an unclean place. To keep your beads clean, it's best to carry them in a special bead bag, also available at the ISKCON temple.)

Aside from chanting *japa*, you can also sing the Lord's holy names in *kirtana*. While you can perform *kirtana* individually, it is generally performed with others. A melodious *kirtana* with family or friends is sure to enliven everyone. ISKCON devotees use traditional melodies and instruments, especially in the temple, but you can chant to any melody and use any musical instruments to accompany your chanting. As Lord Chaitanya said, "There are no hard and fast rules for chanting Hare Krishna."

Ten Offenses against chanting the holy name

The offenses against the chanting of the holy name are as follows:

(1) To blaspheme the devotees who have dedicated their lives for propagating the holy name of the Lord. (2) To consider the names of demigods like Lord Shiva or Lord Brahma to be equal to, or independent of the name of Lord Vishnu. (Sometimes the atheistic class of men take it that any demigod is as good as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Vishnu. But one who is a devotee knows that no demigod, however great he may be, is independently as good as the

Supreme Personality of Godhead. Therefore, if someone thinks that he can chant “Kali, Kali!” or “Durga, Durga!” and it is the same as Hare Krishna, that is the greatest offense.) (3) To disobey the orders of the spiritual master. (4) To blaspheme the Vedic literature or literature in pursuance of the Vedic version. (5) To consider the glories of chanting Hare Krishna to be imagination. (6) To give some interpretation to the holy name of the Lord. (7) To commit sinful activities on the strength of the holy name of the Lord. (It should not be taken that because by chanting the holy name of the Lord one can be freed from all kinds of sinful reaction, one may continue to act sinfully and after that chant Hare Krishna to neutralize his sins. Such a dangerous mentality is very offensive and should be avoided.) (8) To consider the chanting of Hare Krishna as one of the auspicious ritualistic activities offered in the Vedas as fruitive activities (*karma-kāṇḍa*). (9) To instruct a faithless person about the glories of the holy name. (Anyone can take part in chanting the holy name of the Lord, but in the beginning one should not be instructed about the transcendental potency of the Lord. Those who are too sinful cannot appreciate the transcendental glories of the Lord, and therefore it is better not to instruct them in this matter.) (10) To not have complete faith in the chanting of the holy names and to maintain material attachments, even after understanding so many instructions on this matter.

Every devotee who claims to be a Vaishnava must guard against these offenses in order to quickly achieve the desired success. (*Excerpts from Nectar of Devotion*)

Everyday Life: The Four Regulative Principles

Anyone serious about progressing in Krishna consciousness must avoid the following four sinful activities:

1. **Eating meat, fish or eggs.** These foods are saturated with the modes of passion and ignorance and therefore cannot be offered to the Lord.

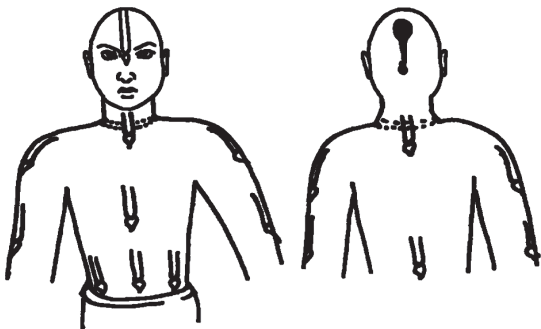
2. **Gambling.** Gambling invariably puts one into anxiety and fuels greed, envy, and anger.

3. **The use of intoxicants.** Drugs, alcohol, and tobacco, as well as any drinks or foods containing caffeine, cloud the mind, overstimulate the senses, and make it impossible to understand or follow the principles of *bhakti-yoga*.

4. **Illicit sex.** This is sex outside of marriage or sex in marriage for any purpose other than procreation.

Marking the Body with Vishnu-tilaka (*ūrdhva-puṇḍra*)

Tilaka refers to marks placed on the body using various substances. *Urdhva-pundra* refers to the two vertical marks placed on the forehead and other parts of the body to indicate surrender to Lord Vishnu. The *Padma Purana* and *Yajur Veda* state that *urdhva-pundra* symbolizes the lotus foot of Vishnu. In the *Padma Purana* it is said: “Persons who mark twelve places of their bodies as Vishnu temples with Vishnu’s symbolic representations, and who have vishnu tilaka on their foreheads, are to be understood as the devotees of Lord Vishnu in this world. Their presence makes the world purified, and anywhere they remain, they



make that place as good as Vaikuntha. A similar statement is in the Skanda Purana, which says, “Persons who are decorated with tilaka or gopi-candana are never approached by the Yamadutas.”

If a devotee applies the marks of the Lord and chants His name, the Lord becomes pleased and resides with him. In this way the material body becomes a sanctified temple of the Lord. The Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa states that a devotee who applies his *tilaka* with great care while looking in a mirror or looking at his reflection in water goes to the Lord’s supreme abode.

The *tilaka* is applied to twelve parts of the body — that is, on the forehead, navel, heart, throat, sides of the abdomen, arms, shoulders, nape of the neck, and lower back. Applying *tilaka* on these places and reciting Vishnu’s names sanctifies and dedicates the body to the Lord’s service.

While decorating the body with *tilaka*, one gives protection to the body by chanting different names of Vishnu. *Tilaka* is applied

to the other parts of the body in the same fashion as it is applied to the forehead. One should mix *tilaka* in the palm of one's left hand (or premix it in a small container) and apply it with the ring finger of the right hand to twelve places on the body while chanting the following *mantras*:

(When applying *tilaka* to the right side of the body transfer it from the ball of the right ring finger onto the ball of the left ring finger.)

The forehead	om̐ keśavāya namaḥ
The abdomen	om̐ nārāyaṇāya namaḥ
The chest	om̐ mādhavāya namaḥ
The throat	om̐ govindāya namaḥ
The right side of abdomen	om̐ viṣṇave namaḥ
The right arm	om̐ madhusūdanāya namaḥ
The right shoulder	om̐ trivikramāya namaḥ
The left side of abdomen	om̐ vāmanāya namaḥ
The left arm	om̐ śrīdharāya namaḥ
The left shoulder	om̐ hr̥ṣīkeśāya namaḥ
The upper back	om̐ padmanābhāya namaḥ
The lower back	om̐ dāmodarāya namaḥ

Whatever *tilaka* is left over should be wiped in the region of the *sikha* with the *mantra* om̐ vāsudevāya namaḥ

Setting Up Your Altar

You are likely to find that your *japa* and *kirtana* are especially effective when done before an altar.

Setting up an altar at home means receiving the Lord and His pure devotees as your most honored guests. Where should you set up the altar? Well, how would you seat a guest? An ideal place would be clean, well lit, and free from drafts and household disturbances. Your guest, of course, would need a comfortable chair, but for the picture of Krishna's form, a wall shelf, a mantelpiece, a corner table, or the top shelf of a bookcase will do.

What do you need for an altar? Here are the essentials:

1. A picture of Srila Prabhupada.
2. A picture of Lord Chaitanya and His associates.
3. A picture of Sri Sri Radha-Krishna.



In addition, you may want an altar cloth, water cups (one for each picture), a lamp, a special plate for offering food, a small bell, incense, an incense holder, and fresh flowers, which you may offer in vases or simply place before each picture. If you're interested in more elaborate Deity worship, consult the devotees at the ISKCON temple.

You can arrange the pictures in a triangle, with the picture of Srila Prabhupada on the left, the picture of Lord Chaitanya and His associates on the right, and the picture of Radha and Krishna, which, if possible, should be slightly larger than the others, on a small raised platform behind and in the center. Or you can hang the picture of Radha and Krishna on the wall above.

Carefully clean the altar each morning. Cleanliness is essential in Deity worship. Remember, you wouldn't neglect to clean the room of an important guest, and when you establish an altar you invite Krishna and His pure devotees to reside as the most exalted guests in your home. If you have water cups, rinse them out and fill them with fresh water daily. Then place them conveniently close to the pictures. You should remove flowers in vases as soon as they're slightly wilted, or daily if you've offered them at the base of the pictures. You should offer fresh incense at least once a day, and, if possible, offer a lamp and place it near the pictures when you're chanting before the altar.

Please try the things we've suggested so far. It's very simple, really: if you try to love God, you'll gradually realize how much He loves you. That's the essence of *bhakti-yoga*.

Prasadam: How to Prepare and Offer Food

Food prepared for and offered to Krishna with love and devotion becomes completely spiritualized. Such food is called Krishna *prasādam*, which means "the mercy of Lord Krishna."

Lord Chaitanya said of *prasadam*, “Everyone has tasted these foods before. However, now that they have been prepared for Krishna and offered to Him with devotion, these foods have acquired extraordinary tastes and uncommon fragrances. Just taste them and see the difference in the experience! Apart from the taste, even the fragrance pleases the mind and makes one forget any other fragrance. Therefore, it should be understood that the spiritual nectar of Krishna’s lips must have touched these ordinary foods and imparted to them all their transcendental qualities.”

Eating only food offered to Krishna is the perfection of vegetarianism. In the Bhagavad-gita Lord Krishna says that unless one eats only food that has been offered to Him in sacrifice, one will suffer the reactions of *karma*. He also states, “If one offers Me with love and devotion a leaf, a flower, a fruit, or water, I will accept it.” From this verse it is understood that we can offer Krishna foods prepared from milk products, vegetables, fruits, nuts, and grains. Meat, fish and eggs are not offerable. And a few vegetarian items are also forbidden—garlic and onions, for example, which are in the mode of darkness. (*Hing*, or asafoetida, is a tasty substitute for them in cooking.) Nor can you offer Krishna coffee or tea.

In preparing food, cleanliness is the most important principle. Nothing impure should be offered to God, so keep your kitchen very clean. Always wash your hands thoroughly before entering the kitchen. While preparing food, *do not taste it*, for you are cooking the meal not for yourself but for the pleasure of Krishna. Arrange positions of the food on dinnerware kept especially for this purpose; no one but the Lord should eat from these dishes. The easiest way to offer food is simply to pray, “My dear Lord Krishna, please accept this food,” and to chant each of the following prayers three times while ringing a bell.

1. Prayer to Srila Prabhupada:

nama om viṣṇu-pādāya kṛṣṇa-preṣṭhāya bhū-tale
śrimate bhaktivedānta-svāmin iti nāmine
namas te sārasvate deve gaura-vāṇī-pracāriṇe
nirviśeṣa-śūnyavādi-pāścātya-deśa-tāriṇe

2. Prayer to Lord Chaitanya:

namo mahā-vadānyāya kṛṣṇa-prema-pradāya te
kṛṣṇāya kṛṣṇa-caitanya-nāmne gaura-tviṣe namaḥ

3. Prayer to Lord Krishna:

namo brahmaṇya-devāya go-brāhmaṇa-hitāya ca
jagad-dhitāya kṛṣṇāya govindāya namo namaḥ

“I offer my respectful obeisances unto Lord Krishna, who is the worshipable Deity for all *brahmanas*, the well-wisher of the cows and the *brahmanas*, and the benefactor of the whole world. I offer my repeated obeisances to the Personality of Godhead, known as Krishna and Govinda.”

Remember that the real purpose of preparing and offering food to the Lord is to show your devotion and gratitude to Him. God is complete in Himself—He doesn’t need anything— but out of His immense kindness He allows us to offer food to Him so that we can develop our love for Him.

After offering the food to the Lord, wait at least five minutes for Him to partake of the preparations. Then you should transfer the food from the special dinnerware and wash the dishes and utensils you used for the offering. Now you and any guests may eat the *prasadam*. While you eat, try to appreciate the spiritual value of the food. Remember

that because Krishna has accepted it, it is nondifferent from Him, and therefore by eating it you will become purified.

Everything you offer on your altar becomes *prasādam*, the mercy of the Lord. Flowers, incense, the water, the food— everything you offer for the Lord’s pleasure becomes spiritualized. Thus remnants of everything offered to the Lord are nondifferent from Him. So you should not only deeply respect the things you’ve offered, but you should distribute them to others as well. Distribution of *prasadam* is an essential part of Deity worship.

Honouring Prasāda

(from *Mahābhārata*, *Skanda Purāṇa*)

mahā-prasāde govinde nāma-brahmaṇi vaiṣṇave
svalpa-puṇya-vatām rājan viśvāso naiva jāyate

O king, for those with little pious credit, faith in *mahā-prasāda*, Śrī Govinda, the holy name, and the *Vaiṣṇavas* never arises.

Prasāda-sevāya

(from *Gītāvalī* by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura)

bhāi-re!

śarīra avidyā-jāl, joḍendriya tāhe kāl,
jīve phele viśaya-sāgore
tā’ra madhye jihvā ati, lobhamoy sudurmati,
tā’ke jetā kathina saṁsāre (1)

O brothers! This material body is a network of ignorance, and the senses are one's deadly enemies, for they throw the soul into the ocean of material sense enjoyment. Among the senses, the tongue is the most voracious and verily wicked; it is very difficult to conquer the tongue in this world.

kr̥ṣṇa baḍo doyāmoy, koribāre jihvā jay,
sva-prasād-anna dilo bhāi
sei annāmṛta pāo, rādhā-kr̥ṣṇa-guṇa gāo,
preme ḍāko caitanya-nitāi (2)

O brothers! Lord Kṛṣṇa is very merciful - just to control the tongue He has given us the remnants of His own food! Now please eat these nectarean grains while singing the glories of Their Lordships Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, and in love call out “Caitanya! Nitāi!”

Ekadashi

(Extracts from the teachings of His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada)

In devotional service there are certain activities which are called determined such as fasting on certain days like the eleventh day of the moon, *Ekadashi* and on other days like appearance day of the Lord. The *Ekadashi* day which comes twice a month, occurs on the eleventh — day after the full moon and the eleventh day after the new moon. On such days no grains, cereals or beans are eaten; simply vegetables and milk** are moderately taken, and chanting Hare Krishna and reading scriptures are increased.

** Devotees observing *Ekadashi* can also take fruits.

In the *Brahma-vaivarta Purana* it is said that one who observes fasting on *Ekadashi* day is freed from all kinds of reactions to sinful activities and advances in pious life. The basic principle is not just to fast, but to increase one's faith and love for Govinda, or Krishna. The real reason for observing fasting on *Ekadashi* is to minimize the demands of the body and to engage our time in the service of the Lord by chanting or performing similar service.

The injunction to fast on *Ekadashi* is especially meant for devotees; on *Ekadashi* there are no restrictions regarding foodstuffs that may be offered to the Lord. On *Ekadashi*, everything is cooked for Vishnu, including regular grains and *dahl*. However it is strictly forbidden for one to accept any kind of grain on *Ekadashi*, even if it is offered to Lord Vishnu.

To observe *Ekadashi-vrata* means to please the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Those interested in advancing in Krishna consciousness must observe *Ekadashi-vrata* regularly. *Ekadashi* fast is broken on the next day i.e. *Dvadashi* by taking grains immediately after sunrise. All these rules and regulations are offered by the great *acharyas* for those who are actually interested in getting admission into the association of the Supreme Personality of Godhead in the transcendental world.

5. Srila Prabhupada Ashraya Program

The important items of *Sadhana Bhakti* are mentioned in the *shastras* as follows:

guru-pādāśraya, dīkṣā,
gurura sevana
sad-dharma-śikṣā, prcchā,
sādhu-mārgānugamana

“On the path of regulative devotional service, one must observe the following items: (1) one must accept a bona fide spiritual master. (2) accept initiation from him. (3) serve him. (4) receive instructions from the spiritual master and make inquiries in order to learn devotional service. (5) follow in the footsteps of the previous *ācāryas* and follow the directions given by the spiritual master.” (CC *Madhya* 22.115)

His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, the founder-*acharya* of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness, elaborates on *guru-pādāśraya* in a lecture as:

“*Ādau gurvāśrayam*. First thing is to accept a bona fide guru. Otherwise there is no devotion. It is simply false imitation. This is the injunction of Rūpa Gosvāmī in *Bhakti-rasāmṛta sindhu*. *Ādau gurvāśrayam*: “your first business is to approach bona fide guru and take his *āśraya*.” Otherwise there is no devotion.” (Evening lecture- Bhubaneswar, January 23, 1977)

Āśraya means to act under the direction and supervision of the spiritual master. Srila Prabhupada writes in the introduction to the *Bhagavad-gita As It Is*:

tasmāt sarveṣu kāleṣu
mām anusmara yudhya ca
mayy arpita-mano-buddhir
mām evaiśyasy asaṁśayaḥ

“Therefore, Arjuna, you should always think of Me in the form of Krishna and at the same time continue your prescribed duty of fighting. With your activities dedicated to Me and your mind and intelligence fixed on Me, you will attain Me without doubt. (Bg. 8.7)

“He (Krishna) does not advise Arjuna simply to remember Him and give up his occupation. No, the Lord never suggests anything impractical. In this material world, in order to maintain the body one has to work. Human society is divided, according to work, into four divisions of social order - *brahmana*, *kshatriya*, *vaishya* and *sudra*. The *brahmana* class or intelligent class is working in one way, the *kshatriya* or administrative class is working in another way, and the mercantile class and the laborer are all tending to their specific duties. In the human society whether one is laborer, merchant, administrator, or farmer, or even if one belongs to the highest class and is a literary man, a scientist or a theologian, he has to work in order to maintain his existence. The Lord therefore tells Arjuna that he need not give up his occupation, but while he is engaged in his occupation he should remember Krishna (*mām anusmara*). If he doesn't practice remembering Krishna while he is struggling for existence, then it will not be possible for him to remember Krishna at the time of death. Lord Chaitanya also advises this. Therefore we have to practice remembering the Lord always, twenty four hours a day, by chanting His names and molding our life's activities in such a way that we can remember Him always.”

Undoubtedly it is important for everyone to practise Krishna consciousness or devotional service to Lord Krishna in their life. The beauty of Krishna consciousness is that you can take up the practices of devotional service to the Lord as much as you are ready, for Krishna Himself promises in the Bhagavad-gita: “There is no loss or diminution in this endeavor, and even a little advancement on this path protects one from the most fearful type of danger.” So bring Krishna into your daily life, and soon you will feel the benefit.

The following are the different levels of commitment and standards of devotional service that you can practice at home while carrying out your normal activities of life. You can choose the level and standard that you can most comfortably practice and ISKCON will offer you guidance and inspiration to practise at that level and help you to gradually reach higher and higher standards.

Levels of Ashraya Program

Srila Prabhupada SHRADDHAVAN

- Chant minimum 1 round of Hare Krishna maha mantra every day
- Read Srila Prabhupada's books regularly
- Attend as many temple programs as possible
- Actively participate in Krishnashraya programs near home
- Render minimum of 4 hrs of practical devotional service in the temple in every quarter of the year (3 months)
- Actively participate in Srila Prabhupada's book distribution for at least 4 hrs in every quarter of the year (3 months)

Srila Prabhupada SEVAKA

- Chant minimum 4 rounds of Hare Krishna maha mantra every day
- Min 3 months after taking SP Shraddhavan Ashraya
- Read Srila Prabhupada's books regularly (Read "Beyond birth & death" completely for the written test)
- Accept Sri Krishna as the Supreme Personality of Godhead
- Attend as many temple programs as possible
- Actively participate in Krishnashraya programs near home
- Render minimum of 8 hrs of practical devotional service in the temple in every quarter of the year (3 months)
- Actively participate in Srila Prabhupada's book distribution for at least 8 hrs in every quarter of the year (3 months)

Srila Prabhupada SADHAKA

- Chant minimum 8 rounds of Hare Krishna maha mantra every day
- Min 3 months after taking SP Sevaka Ashraya
- Read Srila Prabhupada's books regularly (Read "Raja Vidya" & "Perfection of Yoga" completely for the written test)
- Try to rise early morning and complete the sadhana of chanting, worshipping the Lord at home, offering food, etc.
- Fasting on Ekadashi & festival days
- Actively participate and assist in preaching in Krishnashraya programs near home
- Render minimum of 12 hrs of practical devotional service in the temple in every quarter of the year (3 months)
- Actively participate in Srila Prabhupada's book distribution for at least 12 hrs in every quarter of the year (3 months)

- Avoid eating non-vegetarian food

Srila Prabhupada VANDANA

- Chant minimum 12 rounds of Hare Krishna maha mantra every day
- Min 3 months after taking SP Sadhaka Ashraya
- Read Srila Prabhupada's books everyday (Read "Science of self realization" completely for the written test)
- Follow 4 regulative principles as instructed by Srila Prabhupada - No illicit sex, gambling, intoxication including coffee & tea, meat eating including onion & garlic.
- Follow a daily sadhana program including rising early, chanting, a simple morning program consisting of one arati, Srila Prabhupada Guru Puja & attending/ hearing Srimad-Bhagavatam class
- Implement the Krishna Conscious practices at home
- Fast on Ekadashi and festival days
- Actively participate and assist in preaching in Krishnashraya programs near home
- Render minimum of 16 hrs of practical devotional service in the temple in every quarter of the year (3 months)
- Actively participate in Srila Prabhupada's book distribution for at least 16 hrs in every quarter of the year (3 months)

Srila Prabhupada UPASAKA

- Chant minimum 16 rounds of Hare Krishna maha mantra every day
- Minimum of 3 months after taking SP Vandana Ashraya
- Read Srila Prabhupada's books every day (Read "Bhagavad-gita As It Is" from INTRODUCTION to CHAPTER 3 for the written

test)

- Follow 4 regulative principles as instructed by Srila Prabhupada - No illicit sex, gambling, intoxication including coffee & tea, meat eating including onion & garlic.
- Follow a daily sadhana program including rising early, chanting, a simple morning program consisting of one arati, Srila Prabhupada Guru Puja & attending/ hearing Srimad-Bhagavatam class
- Implement the Krishna Conscious practices at home
- Fast on Ekadashi and festival days
- Actively participate and assist in preaching in Krishnashraya programs near home
- Render minimum of 20 hrs of practical devotional service in the temple in every quarter of the year (3 months)
- Actively participate in Srila Prabhupada's book distribution for at least 20 hrs in every quarter of the year (3 months)

Srila Prabhupada CHARANASHRAYA

- Chant minimum 16 rounds of Hare Krishna maha mantra every day
- Minimum of 6 months after taking SP Upasaka Ashraya
- Read Srila Prabhupada's books every day (Read "Bhagavad-gita As It Is" from INTRODUCTION to CHAPTER 12 for the written test)
- Follow 4 regulative principles as instructed by Srila Prabhupada - No illicit sex, gambling, intoxication including coffee & tea, meat eating including onion & garlic.
- Following a daily sadhana program including rising early, chanting, a simple morning program consisting of one arati, Srila Prabhupada Guru Puja & attending/ hearing Srimad-Bhagavatam class

- Implement the Krishna Conscious practices at home
- Fast on Ekadashi and festival days
- Actively participate and take lead role as preacher in Krishnashraya programs near home
- Render minimum of 20 hrs of practical devotional service in the temple in every quarter of the year (3 months)
- Actively participate in Srila Prabhupada's book distribution for at least 20 hrs in every quarter of the year (3 months)

Ashraya ceremony: On special festival days of the year, the Ashraya ceremony will be conducted where the devotees will receive the blessings of Sri Sri Radha Krishnachandra formally from the President, ISKCON, Bangalore.

How you can take part in the Ashraya ceremony: Please fill out the Ashraya ceremony form (available with Krishnashraya cell co-ordinator). Please indicate the level of your practice of Krishna consciousness. You will have to write a test and attend an interview at the temple on a date which will be announced in the temple. Those fortunate devotees who qualify in all respects will be invited to participate in the Ashraya ceremony.

For more details contact: Vasudeva Keshava Dasa, Co-ordinator, Srila Prabhupada Ashraya Programme, ISKCON, Hare Krishna Hill, Chord Road, Rajajinagar, Bangalore - 560 010. Tel: 23471956, 23578346.

6. Prayers

Śrī Brahma-saṁhitā

īśvaraḥ paramaḥ kṛṣṇaḥ
sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ
anādir ādir govindaḥ
sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam

cintāmaṇi-prakara-sadmasu kalpa-vṛkṣa-
lakṣāvṛteṣu surabhīr abhipālayantam
lakṣmī-sahasra-śata-sambhrama-sevya-mānaṁ
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
veṇuṁ kvaṇantam aravinda-dalāyatākṣaṁ
barhāvataṁsam asitāmbuda-sundarāṅgam
kandarpa-koṭi-kaminīya-viśeṣa-śobhaṁ
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
ālola-candraka-lasad-vanamālya-vamśi-
ratnāṅgadaṁ praṇaya-keli-kalā-vilāsam
śyāmaṁ tri-bhaṅga-lalitāṁ niyata-prakāśaṁ
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
aṅgāni yasya sakalendriya-vṛtti-manti
paśyanti pānti kalayanti ciraṁ jaganti
ānanda-cinmaya-sad-ujjvala-vigrahasya
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
advaitam acyutam anādim ananta-rūpam
ādyam purāṇa-puruṣaṁ nava-yauvanaṁ ca
vedeṣu durlabham adurlabham ātma-bhaktau
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi

panthās tu koṭi-śata-vatsara-sampragamyō
 vāyor athāpi manaso muni-puṅgavānām
 so 'py asti yat-prapada-sīmny avicintya-tattve
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 eko 'py asau racayitum jagad-aṇḍa-koṭim
 yac-chaktir asti jagad-aṇḍa-cayā yad antaḥ
 aṇḍāntara-stha-paramāṇu-cayāntara-stham
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 yad-bhāva-bhāvita-dhiyo manujās tathaiva
 samprāpya rūpa-mahimāsana-yāna-bhūṣāḥ
 sūktair yam eva nigama-prathitaiḥ stuvanti
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 ānanda-cinmaya-rasa-pratibhāvitābhis
 tābhir ya eva nija-rūpataya kalābhiḥ
 goloka eva nivasaty akhilātma-bhūto
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 premāñjana-cchurita-bhakti-vilocanena
 santaḥ sadaiva hṛdayeṣu vilokayanti
 yām śyāmasundaram acintya-guṇa-svarūpaṁ
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 rāmādi-mūrtiṣu kalā-niyamena tiṣṭhan
 nānāvātāram akarod bhuvaneṣu kintu
 kṛṣṇaḥ svayaṁ samabhavat paramaḥ pumān yo
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 yasya prabhā prabhavato jagad-aṇḍa-koṭi-
 koṭiṣv aśeṣa-vasudhādi vibhūti-bhinnaṁ
 tad brahma niṣkalam anantam aśeṣa-bhūtaṁ
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi

mājā hi yasya jagad-aṇḍa-śatāni sūte
 traiguṇya-tad-viṣaya-veda-vitāyamānā
 sattvāvalambī-para-sattvaṁ viśuddha-sattvaṁ
 govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
 ānanda-cinmaya-rasātmatayā manaḥsu
 yaḥ prāṇināṁ pratiphalan smarātām upetya
 līlāyitena bhuvanāni jayaty ajasraṁ
 govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
 goloka-nāmni nija-dhāmni tale ca tasya
 devī-maheśa-hari-dhāmasu teṣu teṣu
 te te prabhāva-nicayā vihitās ca yena
 govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
 sṛṣṭi-sthiti-pralaya-sādhana-śaktir ekā
 chāyeva yasya bhuvanāni bibharti durgā
 icchānurūpam api yasya ca ceṣṭate sā
 govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
 kṣīraṁ yathā dadhi vikāra-viśeṣa-yogāt
 sañjāyate na hi tataḥ prthag asti hetoḥ
 yaḥ śambhutām api tathā samupaiti kār्याd
 govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
 dīpārcir eva hi daśāntaram abhyupetya
 dīpāyate vivṛta-hetu-samāna-dharmā
 yas tādṛg eva hi ca viṣṇutayā vibhāti
 govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
 yaḥ kāraṇārṇava-jale bhajati sma yoga-
 nidrām ananta-jagad-aṇḍa-sa-roma-kūpaḥ
 ādhāra-śaktim avalambya parām sva-mūrtim
 govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi

yasyaika-niśvasita-kālam athāvalambya
 jīvanti loma-vilajā jagad-aṇḍa-nāthāḥ
 viṣṇur mahān sa iha yasya kalā-viśeṣo
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 bhāsvān yathāśma-śakaleṣu nijeṣu tejaḥ
 svīyam kiyat prakāṣayaty api tadvad atra
 brahmā ya eṣa jagad-aṇḍa-vidhāna-kartā
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 yat-pāda-pallava-yugam vinidhāya kumbha-
 dvandve praṇāma-samaye sa gaṇādhirājaḥ
 vighnān vihartum alam asya jagat-trayasya
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 agnir mahī gaganam ambu marud diśaś ca
 kālas tathātma-manasīti jagat-trayāṇi
 yasmād bhavanti vibhavanti viśanti yaṁ ca
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 yac-cakṣur eṣa savitā sakala-grahāṇām
 rājā samasta-sura-mūrtir aśeṣa-tejaḥ
 yasyājñayā bhramati sambhṛta-kāla-cakro
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 dharmo 'tha pāpa-nicayaḥ śrutayas tapāmsi
 brahmādi-kīṭa-patagāvadhayaś ca jīvāḥ
 yad-datta-mātra-vibhava-prakāṣa-prabhāva
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi
 yas tv indragopam athavendram aho sva-karma-
 bandhānurūpa-phala-bhājanam ātanoti
 karmāṇi nirdahati kintu ca bhakti-bhājām
 govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi

yaṁ krodha-kāma-sahaja-praṇayādi-bhīti-
vātsalya-moha-guru-gaurava-sevya-bhāvaiḥ
sañcintya tasya sadṛśīm tanum āpur ete
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
śrīyaḥ kāntāḥ kāntāḥ parama-puruṣaḥ kalpa-taravo
drumā bhūmiś cintāmaṇi-gaṇa-mayī toyam amṛtam
kathā gānaṁ nāṭyaṁ gamanam api vaṁśī priya-sakhī
cid-ānandaṁ jyotiḥ param api tad āsvādyam api ca
sa yatra kṣīrābdhiḥ sravati surabhībhyaś ca su-mahān
nimeṣārdhākhyo vā vrajati na hi yatrāpi samayaḥ
bhaje śvetadvīpaṁ tam ahaṁ iha golokam iti yaṁ
vidantas te santaḥ kṣiti-virala-cārāḥ katipaye

Śrīmatī Kuntīdevī's Prayers

kunty uvāca

namasye puruṣaṁ tvādyam
īśvaraṁ prakṛteḥ param
alakṣyaṁ sarva-bhūtānām
antar bahir avasthitam

Śrīmatī Kuntī said: O Kṛṣṇa, I offer my obeisances unto You because You are the original personality of God and are unaffected by the qualities of the material world. You are existing both within and without everything, yet You are invisible to all.

māyā-javanikācchannam
ajñādhokṣajam avyayam
na lakṣyase mūḍha-dṛśā
naṭo nātyadharo yathā

Being beyond the range of limited sense perception, You are the eternally irreproachable factor covered by the curtain of deluding energy. You are invisible to the foolish observer, exactly as an actor dressed as a player is not recognized.

tathā paramahamsānām
muninām amalātmanām
bhakti-yoga-vidhānārthaṁ
kathaṁ paśyema hi striyaḥ

You Yourself descend to propagate the transcendental science of devotional service unto the hearts of the advanced transcendentalists and mental speculators, who are purified by being able to discriminate between matter and spirit. How, then, can we women know You perfectly?

kr̥ṣṇāya vāsudevāya
devakī-nandanāya ca
nanda-gopa-kumārāya
govindāya namo namaḥ

Let me therefore offer my respectful obeisances unto the Lord, who has become the son of Vasudeva, the pleasure of Devakī, the boy of Nanda and the other cowherd men of Vṛndāvana, and the enlivener of the cows and the senses.

namaḥ paṅkaja-nābhāya
namaḥ paṅkaja-māline
namaḥ paṅkaja-netrāya
namas te paṅkajāṅghraye

My respectful obeisances are unto You, O Lord, whose abdomen is marked with a depression like a lotus flower, who are always decorated with garlands of lotus flowers, whose glance is as cool as the lotus and whose feet are engraved with lotuses.

yathā hṛṣīkeśa khalena devakī
kaṁsena ruddhāticiraṁ śucārpitā
vimocitāhaṁ ca sahātmajā vibho
tvayaiva nāthena muhur vipad-gaṇāt

O Hṛṣīkeśa, master of the senses and Lord of lords, You have released Your mother, Devakī, who was long imprisoned and distressed by the envious King Kaṁsa, and me and my children from a series of constant dangers.

viṣān mahāgneḥ puruṣāda-darśanād
asat-sabhāyā vana-vāsa-kṛcchrataḥ
mṛdhe mṛdhe 'neka-mahārathāstrato
drauṇy-astrataś cāsma hare 'bhirakṣitāḥ

My dear Kṛṣṇa, Your Lordship has protected us from a poisoned cake, from a great fire, from cannibals, from the vicious assembly, from sufferings during our exile in the forest and from the battle where great generals fought. And now You have saved us from the weapon of Aśvatthāmā.

**vipadaḥ santu tāḥ śāśvat
tatra tatra jagad-guro
bhavato darśanaṁ yat syād
apunar bhava-darśanam**

I wish that all those calamities would happen again and again so that we could see You again and again, for seeing You means that we will no longer see repeated births and deaths.

**janmaśvarya-śruta-śrībhir
edhamāna-madaḥ pumān
naivārhaty abhidhātum vai
tvām akiñcana-gocaram**

My Lord, Your Lordship can easily be approached, but only by those who are materially exhausted. One who is on the path of [material] progress, trying to improve himself with respectable parentage, great opulence, high education and bodily beauty, cannot approach You with sincere feeling.

**namo 'kiñcana-vittāya
nivr̥tta-guṇa-vr̥ttaye
ātmārāmāya śāntāya
kaivalya-pataye namaḥ**

My obeisances are unto You, who are the property of the materially impoverished. You have nothing to do with the actions and reactions of the material modes of nature. You are self-satisfied, and therefore You are the most gentle and are master of the monists.

manye tvām kālam īśānam
anādi-nidhanam vibhum
samam carantan sarvatra
bhūtānām yan mithaḥ kaliḥ

My Lord, I consider Your Lordship to be eternal time, the supreme controller, without beginning and end, the all-pervasive one. In distributing Your mercy, You are equal to everyone. The dissensions between living beings are due to social intercourse.

na veda kaścīd bhagavaṁś cikīrṣitaṁ
tavehamānasya nṛṇām viḍambanam
na yasya kaścīd dayito 'sti karhicid
dveṣyaś ca yasmin viṣamā matir nṛṇām

O Lord, no one can understand Your transcendental pastimes, which appear to be human and are so misleading. You have no specific object of favor, nor do You have any object of envy. People only imagine that You are partial.

janma karma ca viśvātmann
ajasyākartur ātmanaḥ
tiryāṇ-nṛṣiṣu yādaḥsu
tad atyanta-viḍambanam

Of course it is bewildering, O soul of the universe, that You work, though You are inactive, and that You take birth, though You are the vital force and the unborn. You Yourself descend amongst animals, men, sages and aquatics. Verily, this is bewildering.

gopy ādade tvayi kṛtāgasi dāma tāvad
yā te daśāśru-kalilāñjana-sambhramākṣam
vaktraṁ ninīya bhaya-bhāvanayā sthitasya
sā mām vimohayati bhīr api yad bibheti

My dear Kṛṣṇa, Yaśodā took up a rope to bind You when You committed an offense, and Your perturbed eyes overflowed with tears, which washed the mascara from Your eyes. And You were afraid, though fear personified is afraid of You. This sight is bewildering to me.

kecid āhur ajam jātam
puṇya-ślokasya kīrtaye
yadoḥ priyasyānvavāye
malayasyeva candanam

Some say that the unborn is born for the glorification of pious kings, and others say that He is born to please King Yadu, one of Your dearest devotees. You appear in his family as sandalwood appears in the Malaya hills.

apare vasudevasya
devakyām yācito 'bhyagāt
ajas tvam asya kṣemāya
vadhāya ca sura-dviṣām

Others say that since both Vasudeva and Devakī prayed for You, You have taken Your birth as their son. Undoubtedly You are unborn, yet You take Your birth for their welfare and to kill those who are envious of the demigods.

bhārāvatāraṇāyānye
bhuvo nāva ivodadhau
sīdantya bhūri-bhāreṇa
jāto hy ātma-bhuvārthitah

Others say that the world, being overburdened like a boat at sea, is much aggrieved, and that Brahmā, who is Your son, prayed for You, and so You have appeared to diminish the trouble.

bhave 'smin kliśyamānānām
avidyā-kāma-karmabhiḥ
śravaṇa-smaraṇārhāṇi
kariṣyann iti kecana

And yet others say that You appeared to rejuvenate the devotional service of hearing, remembering, worshiping and so on in order that the conditioned souls suffering from material pangs might take advantage and gain liberation.

śṛṇvanti gāyanti gr̥ṇanty abhīkṣṇaśaḥ
smaranti nandanti tavehitam janāḥ
ta eva paśyanty acireṇa tāvakam
bhava-pravāhoparamam padāmbujam

O Kṛṣṇa, those who continuously hear, chant and repeat Your transcendental activities, or take pleasure in others' doing so, certainly see Your lotus feet, which alone can stop the repetition of birth and death.

apy adya nas tvaṁ sva-kṛteḥita prabho
jihāsasi svit suhr̥do 'nujīvināḥ
yeśām na cānyad bhavataḥ padāmbujāt
parāyaṇam rājasu yojitāmhasām

O my Lord, You have executed all duties Yourself. Are You leaving us today, though we are completely dependent on Your mercy and have no one else to protect us, now when all kings are at enmity with us?

ke vyaṁ nāma-rūpābhyām
yadubhiḥ saha pāṇḍavāḥ
bhavato 'darśanam yarhi
hr̥ṣikāṇām iveśituḥ

As the name and fame of a particular body is finished with the disappearance of the living spirit, similarly if You do not look upon us, all our fame and activities, along with the Pāṇḍavas and Yadus, will end at once.

neyaṁ śobhiṣyate tatra
yathedānīm gadādhara
tvat-padair aṅkitā bhāti
sva-lakṣaṇa-vilakṣitaiḥ

O Gadādhara [Kṛṣṇa], our kingdom is now being marked by the impressions of Your feet, and therefore it appears beautiful. But when You leave, it will no longer be so.

ime jana-padāḥ svṛddhāḥ
supakvauṣadhi-vīrudhaḥ
vanādri-nady-udanvanto
hy edhante tava vīkṣitaiḥ

All these cities and villages are flourishing in all respects because the herbs and grains are in abundance, the trees are full of fruits, the rivers are flowing, the hills are full of minerals and the oceans full of wealth. And this is all due to Your glancing over them.

atha viśveśa viśvātman
viśva-mūrte svakeṣu me
sneha-pāśam imam chindhi
dṛḍham pāṇḍuṣu vṛṣṇiṣu

O Lord of the universe, soul of the universe, O personality of the form of the universe, please, therefore, sever my tie of affection for my kinsmen, the Pāṇḍavas and the Vṛṣṇis.

tvayi me 'nanya-viṣayā
matir madhu-pate 'sakṛt
ratim udvahatād addhā
gaṅgevaugham udanvati

O Lord of Madhu, as the Ganges forever flows to the sea without hindrance, let my attraction be constantly drawn unto You without being diverted to anyone else.

śrī-kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa-sakha vṛṣṇy-ṛṣabhāvani-dhruḡ-
rājanya-vaṁśa-dahanānapavarga-vīrya
govinda go-dvija-surārṭi-harāvātāra
yogeśvarākhila-guro bhagavan namas te

O Kṛṣṇa, O friend of Arjuna, O chief amongst the descendants of Vṛṣṇi, You are the destroyer of those political parties which are disturbing elements on this earth. Your prowess never deteriorates. You are the proprietor of the transcendental abode, and You descend to relieve the distresses of the cows, the *brāhmaṇas* and the devotees. You possess all mystic powers, and You are the preceptor of the entire universe. You are the almighty God, and I offer You my respectful obeisances.

Śrī Śukadeva Gosvāmī's Prayers

śrī-śuka uvāca

namaḥ parasmai puruṣāya bhūyase
sad-udbhava-sthāna-nirodha-līlayā
grhīta-śakti-tritayāya dehinām
antarbhavāyānupalakṣya-vartmane

Śukadeva Gosvāmī said: Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead who, for the creation of the material world, accepts the three modes of nature. He is the complete whole residing within the body of everyone, and His ways are inconceivable.

bhūyo namaḥ sad-vṛjina-cchide 'satām
asambhavāyākhila-sattva-mūrtaye
puṁsām punaḥ pāramahaṁsya āśrame
vyavasthitānām anumṛgya-dāśuṣe

I again offer my respectful obeisances unto the form of complete existence and transcendence, who is the liberator of the pious devotees from all distresses and the destroyer of the further advances in atheistic temperament of the nondevotee-demons. For the transcendentalists who are situated in the topmost spiritual perfection, He grants their specific destinations.

namo namas te 'stv ṛṣabhāya sātvatām
vidūra-kāṣṭhāya muhuḥ kuyoginām
nirasta-sāmyātiśayena rādhasā
sva-dhāmani brahmaṇi raṁsyate namaḥ

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto He who is the associate of the members of the Yadu dynasty and who is always a problem for

the nondevotees. He is the supreme enjoyer of both the material and spiritual worlds, yet He enjoys His own abode in the spiritual sky. There is no one equal to Him because His transcendental opulence is immeasurable.

yat-kīrtanam yat-smaraṇam yad-īkṣaṇam
yad-vandanam yac-chravaṇam yad-arhaṇam
lokasya sadyo vidhunoti kalmaṣam
tasmai subhadra-śravase namo namaḥ

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto the all-auspicious Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, about whom glorification, remembrances, audience, prayers, hearing and worship can at once cleanse the effects of all sins of the performer.

vicakṣaṇā yac-caraṇopasādanāt
saṅgam vyudasyobhayato 'ntar-ātmanah
vindanti hi brahma-gatiṁ gata-klamās
tasmai subhadra-śravase namo namaḥ

Let me offer my respectful obeisances again and again unto the all-auspicious Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa. The highly intellectual, simply by surrendering unto His lotus feet, are relieved of all attachments to present and future existences and without difficulty progress toward spiritual existence.

tapasvino dāna-parā yaśasvino
manasvino mantra-vidaḥ sumāṅgalāḥ
kṣemam na vindanti vinā yad-arpaṇam
tasmai subhadra-śravase namo namaḥ

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto the all-auspicious Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa again and again because the great learned sages, the

great performers of charity, the great workers of distinction, the great philosophers and mystics, the great chanters of the Vedic hymns and the great followers of Vedic principles cannot achieve any fruitful result without dedication of such great qualities to the service of the Lord.

kirāta-hūṇāndhra-pulinda-pulkaśā
ābhīra-śumbhā yavanāḥ khasādayaḥ
ye 'nye ca pāpā yad-apāśrayāśrayāḥ
śudhyanti tasmai prabhaviṣṇave namaḥ

Kirāta, Hūṇa, Āndhra, Pulinda, Pulkaśa, Ābhīra, Śumbha, Yavana, members of the Khasa races and even others addicted to sinful acts can be purified by taking shelter of the devotees of the Lord, due to His being the supreme power. I beg to offer my respectful obeisances unto Him.

sa eṣa ātmātmavatām adhiśvaras
trayīmayo dharmamayas tapomayaḥ
gata-vyālikair aja-śaṅkarādibhir
vitarkya-liṅgo bhagavān prasīdatām

He is the Supersoul and the Supreme Lord of all self-realized souls. He is the personification of the Vedas, religious scriptures and austerities. He is worshiped by Lord Brahmā and Śiva and all those who are transcendental to all pretensions. Being so revered with awe and veneration, may that Supreme Absolute be pleased with me.

śriyaḥ patir yajña-patiḥ prajā-patir
dhiyām patir loka-patir dharā-patiḥ
patir gatiś cāndhaka-vṛṣṇi-sātvatām
prasīdatām me bhagavān satām patiḥ

May Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who is the worshipable Lord of all devotees,

the protector and glory of all the kings like Andhaka and Vṛṣṇi of the Yadu dynasty, the husband of all goddesses of fortune, the director of all sacrifices and therefore the leader of all living entities, the controller of all intelligence, the proprietor of all planets, spiritual and material, and the supreme incarnation on the earth (the supreme all in all), be merciful upon me.

yad-aṅghry-abhidhyāna-samādhī-dhautayā
dhiyānupaśyanti hi tattvam ātmanah
vadanti caitat kavayo yathā-rucam
sa me mukundo bhagavān prasīdatām

It is the Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa who gives liberation. By thinking of His lotus feet at every second, following in the footsteps of authorities, the devotee in trance can see the Absolute Truth. The learned mental speculators, however, think of Him according to their whims. May the Lord be pleased with me.

pracoditā yena purā sarasvatī
vitanvatājasya satīm smṛtiṁ hṛdi
sva-lakṣaṇā prādurabhūt kilāsyataḥ
sa me ṛṣiṇām ṛṣabhaḥ prasīdatām

May the Lord, who in the beginning of the creation amplified the potent knowledge of Brahmā from within his heart and inspired him with full knowledge of creation and of His own Self, and who appeared to be generated from the mouth of Brahmā, be pleased with me.

bhūtair mahadbhir ya imāḥ puro vibhur
nirmāya śete yad amūṣu pūruṣaḥ
bhuṅkte guṇān ṣoḍaśa ṣoḍaśātmakāḥ
so 'laṅkṛṣīṣṭa bhagavān vacāmsi me

May the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who enlivens the

materially created bodies of the elements by lying down within the universe, and who in His puruṣa incarnation causes the living being to be subjected to the sixteen divisions of material modes which are his generator, be pleased to decorate my statements.

namas tasmai bhagavate
vāsudevāya vedhase
papur jñānam ayaṁ saumyā
yan-mukhāmburuhāsavam

I offer my respectful obeisances unto Śrīla Vyāsadeva, the incarnation of Vāsudeva who compiled the Vedic scriptures. The pure devotees drink up the nectarean transcendental knowledge dropping from the lotuslike mouth of the Lord.

Dhruva Mahārāja's Prayers

dhruva uvāca

yo 'ntaḥ praviśya mama vācam imām prasuptām
sañjīvayaty akhila-śakti-dharaḥ sva-dhāmnā
anyāṁś ca hasta-caraṇa-śravaṇa-tvag-ādīn
prāṇān namo bhagavate puruṣāya tubhyam

Dhruva Mahārāja said: My dear Lord, You are all-powerful. After entering within me, You have enlivened all my sleeping senses—my hands, legs, ears, touch sensation, life force and especially my power of speech. Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto You.

ekas tvam eva bhagavann idam ātma-śaktyā
māyākhyayoru-guṇayā mahad-ādy-aśeṣam
sṛṣṭvānuviśya puruṣas tad-asad-guṇeṣu
nāneva dāruṣu vibhāvasuvad vibhāsi

My Lord, You are the supreme one, but by Your different energies You appear differently in the spiritual and material worlds. You create the total energy of the material world by Your external potency, and after creation You enter within the material world as the Supersoul. You are the Supreme Person, and through the temporary modes of material nature You create varieties of manifestation, just as fire, entering into wood of different shapes, burns brilliantly in different varieties.

tvad-dattayā vayunayedam acaṣṭa viśvaṁ
supta-prabuddha iva nātha bhavat-prapannaḥ
tasyāpavargya-śaraṇaṁ tava pāda-mūlaṁ
vismaryate kṛta-vidā katham ārta-bandho

O my master, Lord Brahmā is fully surrendered unto You. In the beginning You gave him knowledge, and thus he could see and

understand the entire universe, just as a person awakens from sleep and visualizes his immediate duties. You are the only shelter of all persons who desire liberation, and You are the friend of all who are distressed. How, therefore, can a learned person who has perfect knowledge ever forget You?

nūnaṁ vimuṣṭa-matayas tava māyayā te
ye tvāṁ bhavāpyaya-vimokṣaṇam anya-hetoḥ
arcanti kalpaka-taruṁ kuṇapopabhogyam
icchanti yat sparśajam niraye 'pi nṛṇām

Persons who worship You simply for the sense gratification of this bag of skin are certainly influenced by Your illusory energy. In spite of having You, who are like a desire tree and are the cause of liberation from birth and death, foolish persons, such as me, desire benedictions from You for sense gratification, which is available even for those who live in hellish conditions.

yā nirvṛtis tanu-bhṛtām tava pāda-padma-
dhyānād bhavaj-jana-kathā-śravaṇena vā syāt
sā brahmaṇi sva-mahimany api nātha mā bhūt
kiṁ tv antakāsi-lulitāt patatām vimānāt

My Lord, the transcendental bliss derived from meditating upon Your lotus feet or hearing about Your glories from pure devotees is so unlimited that it is far beyond the stage of *brahmānanda*, wherein one thinks himself merged in the impersonal *Brahman* as one with the Supreme. Since *brahmānanda* is also defeated by the transcendental bliss derived from devotional service, then what to speak of the temporary blissfulness of elevating oneself to the heavenly planets, which is ended by the separating sword of time? Although one may be elevated to the heavenly planets, he falls down in due course of time.

**bhaktiṁ muhuḥ pravahatām tvayi me prasaṅgo
bhūyād ananta mahatām amalāśayānām
yenāñjasolbaṇam uru-vyasanam bhavābधिṁ
neṣye bhavad-guṇa-kathāmr̥ta-pāna-mattah**

Dhruva Mahārāja continued: O unlimited Lord, kindly bless me so that I may associate with great devotees who engage in Your transcendental loving service constantly, as the waves of a river constantly flow. Such transcendental devotees are completely situated in an uncontaminated state of life. By the process of devotional service I shall surely be able to cross the nescient ocean of material existence, which is filled with the waves of blazing, firelike dangers. It will be very easy for me, for I am becoming mad to hear about Your transcendental qualities and pastimes, which are eternally existent.

**te na smaranty atitarām priyam īśa martyam
ye cānv adaḥ suta-suhṛd-gr̥ha-vitta-dārāḥ
ye tv abja-nābha bhavadīya-padāravinda-
saugandhya-lubdha-hṛdayeṣu kṛta-prasaṅgāḥ**

O Lord who have a lotus navel, if a person happens to associate with a devotee whose heart always hankers after Your lotus feet, seeking always their fragrance, he is never attached to the material body or, in a bodily relationship, to offspring, friends, home, wealth and wife, which are very, very dear to materialistic persons. Indeed, he does not care for them.

**tiryāṇ-naga-dvija-sarīsr̥pa-deva-daitya-
martyādibhiḥ paricitam sad-asad-viśeṣam
rūpaṁ sthaviṣṭham aja te mahad-ādy-anekaṁ
nātaḥ paraṁ parama vedmi na yatra vādaḥ**

My dear Lord, O Supreme Unborn, I know that the different varieties of living entities, such as animals, trees, birds, reptiles, demigods and human beings, are spread throughout the universe, which is caused by the total material energy, and I know that they are sometimes manifest and sometimes unmanifest; but I have never experienced the supreme form I behold as I see You now. Now all kinds of methods of theorizing have come to an end.

kalpānta etad akhilaṁ jaṭhareṇa grhṇan
śete pumān sva-dṛg ananta-sakhas tad-aṅke
yan-nābhi-sindhu-ruha-kāñcana-loka-padma-
garbhe dyumān bhagavate praṇato 'smi tasmai

My dear Lord, at the end of each millennium the Supreme Personality of Godhead *Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu* dissolves everything manifested within the universe into His belly. He lies down on the lap of Śeṣa Nāga, from His navel sprouts a golden lotus flower on a stem, and on that lotus Lord Brahmā is created. I can understand that You are the same Supreme Godhead. I therefore offer my respectful obeisances unto You.

tvam nitya-mukta-pariśuddha-vibuddha ātmā
kūṭa-stha ādi-puruṣo bhagavāns try-adhīśaḥ
yad-buddhy-avasthitim akhaṇḍitayā sva-dṛṣṭyā
draṣṭā sthitāv adhimakho vyatirikta āsse

My Lord, by Your unbroken transcendental glance You are the supreme witness of all stages of intellectual activities. You are eternally liberated, Your existence is situated in pure goodness, and You are existent in the Supersoul without change. You are the original Personality of Godhead, full with six opulences, and You are eternally the master of the three modes of material nature. Thus, You are always

different from the ordinary living entities. As Lord Viṣṇu, You maintain all the affairs of the entire universe, and yet You stand aloof and are the enjoyer of the results of all sacrifices.

yasmin viruddha-gatayo hy anīṣaṁ patanti
vidyādayo vividha-śaktaya ānupūrvyāt
tad brahma viśva-bhavam ekam anantam ādyam
ānanda-mātram avikāram ahaṁ prapadye

My dear Lord, in Your impersonal manifestation of *Brahman* there are always two opposing elements—knowledge and ignorance. Your multienergies are continually manifest, but the impersonal *Brahman*, which is undivided, original, changeless, unlimited and blissful, is the cause of the material manifestation. Because You are the same impersonal *Brahman*, I offer my respectful obeisances unto You.

satyāśiṣo hi bhagavaṁs tava pāda-padmam
āśis tathānubhajataḥ puruṣārtha-mūrteḥ
apy evaṁ aṛya bhagavān paripāti dīnān
vāśreva vatsakam anugraha-kātaro 'smān

My Lord, O Supreme Lord, You are the supreme personified form of all benediction. Therefore, for one who abides in Your devotional service with no other desire, worshipping Your lotus feet is better than becoming king and lording it over a kingdom. That is the benediction of worshipping Your lotus feet. To ignorant devotees like me, You are the causelessly merciful maintainer, just like a cow, who takes care of the newly born calf by supplying milk and giving it protection from attack.

sthānābhilāṣī tapasi sthito 'haṁ
tvām prāptavān deva-munīndra-guhyam
kācam vicinvān api divya-ratnam
svāmin kṛtārtho 'smi varam na yāce

“[When he was being blessed by the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Dhruva Mahārāja said:] ‘O my Lord, because I was seeking an opulent material position, I was performing severe types of penance and austerity. Now I have gotten You, who are very difficult for the great demigods, saintly persons and kings to attain. I was searching after a piece of glass, but instead I have found a most valuable jewel. Therefore I am so satisfied that I do not wish to ask any benediction from You.’ (From *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*)

Śrī Śrī Śikṣāṣṭakam

1.

ceto-darpaṇa-mārjanam bhava-mahādāvāgni-nirvāpaṇam
śreyah kairava-candrikāvitarāṇam vidyāvadhūjīvanam
ānandāmbudhi-varḍhanam pratipadam pūrṇāmṛtāsvādanam
sarvātma-snapanam param vijayate śrī-kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtanam

Glory to the Śrī Kṛṣṇa saṅkīrtana, which cleanses the heart of all the dust accumulated for years and extinguishes the fire of conditional life, of repeated birth and death. This saṅkīrtana movement is the prime benediction for humanity at large because it spreads the rays of the benediction moon. It is the life of all transcendental knowledge. It increases the ocean of transcendental bliss, and it enables us to fully taste the nectar for which we are always anxious.

2.

nāmnāmakāri bahudhā nija-sarva-śaktis
tatrārpitā niyamitaḥ smaraṇe na kālāḥ
etādṛśī tava kṛpā bhagavan mamāpi
durdaivamidṛśamihājani nānurāgaḥ

O my Lord, Your holy name alone can render all benediction to living beings, and thus You have hundreds and millions of names like Kṛṣṇa and Govinda. In these transcendental names You have invested all Your transcendental energies, and there are no hard and fast rules for chanting these names. O my Lord, out of kindness You enable us to easily approach You by chanting Your holy names, but I am so unfortunate that I have no attraction for them.

3.

trṇādapi sunīcena
taror api sahiṣṇunā
amāninā mānadena
kīrtaniyaḥ sadā hariḥ

One should chant the holy name of the Lord in a humble state of mind, thinking oneself lower than the straw in the street; one should be more tolerant than a tree, devoid of all sense of false prestige and should be ready to offer all respect to others. In such a state of mind one can chant the holy name of the Lord constantly.

4.

na dhanam na janam na sundarīm
kavitām vā jagadīśa kāmaye
mama janmani janmanīśvare
bhavatādbhaktir ahaitakī tvayi

O almighty Lord, I have no desire to accumulate wealth, nor do I desire to enjoy beautiful women, nor do I want any number of followers. I only want Your causeless devotional service in my life birth after birth.

5.

ayi nandatanuja kiṅkaram
patitam mām viṣame bhavāmbudhau
krpayā tava pāda-paṅkaja-
sthita-dhūlisadṛśam vicintaya

O son of Mahārāja Nanda [Kṛṣṇa], I am Your eternal servitor, yet somehow or other I have fallen into the ocean of birth and death. Please pick me up from this ocean of death and place me as one of the atoms of Your lotus feet.

6.

nayanam galadaśrudhārayā
vadanam gadgadaruddhayā girā
pulakair nicitam vapuḥ kadā
tava nāmagrahaṇe bhaviṣyati

O my Lord, when will my eyes be decorated with tears of love flowing constantly when I chant Your holy name? When will my voice choke up, and when will the hairs of my body stand on end at the recitation of Your name?

7.

yugāyitam nimeṣeṇa
cakṣuṣā prāvṛṣāyitam
śūnyāyitam jagat-sarvaṁ
govinda-virahaṇa me

O Govinda! Feeling Your separation, I am considering a moment to be like twelve years or more. Tears are flowing from my eyes like torrents of rain, and I am feeling all vacant in the world in Your absence.

8.

āśliṣya vā pādaratām pinaṣtu mām
adarśanānmarmahatām karotu vā
yathā tathā vā vidadhātu lampāto
mat-prāṇa-nāthas tu sa eva nāparaḥ

I know no one but Kṛṣṇa as my Lord, and He shall remain so even if He handles me roughly in His embrace or makes me brokenhearted by not being present before me. He is completely free to do anything and everything, for He is always my worshipful Lord unconditionally.

Śrī Venkateśa Suprabhātam

kausalyāsuprajārāma!
pūrvā sandhyā pravartate,
uttiṣṭha naraśārdūla!
kartavyam daivam āhnikam (1)

O Rāma, Kausalya's auspicious child! Twilight is appearing in the East. O best of men (i.e., Puruṣottama)! Wake up, the divine daily-rituals have to be performed.

uttiṣṭhottiṣṭha govinda!
uttiṣṭha garuḍadhvaja!
uttiṣṭha kamalākānta!
trailokyam maṅgalaṁ kuru (2)

O Govinda, wake up! O Garuḍadhvaja (i.e., one who has *Garuḍa* on the banner)! Wake up. O Kamalākānta ! (i.e., the husband of Kamalā) (rising) render the three worlds auspicious.

mātas samasta-jagatām madhukaiṭabhāreḥ
vakṣovihāriṇi! manohara-divyamūrte!
śrīsvāmini śritajanapriya-dānaśīle!
śrī-venkateśa-dayite! tava suprabhātam (3)

May it be an auspicious dawn (morning) to Thee, O Lakṣmī, the Mother of the Worlds, the ever-dweller on the chest of Viṣṇu (i.e., the enemy of the demons, Madhu and Kaiṭabha), of attractive and divine form, the Mistress, and of the nature of granting the desired objects of those seeking refuge!

tava suprabhātam aravindalocane!
bhavatu prasannamukha-candramaṇḍale!

vidhiśaṅkarendra-vanitābhir arcite
vr̥ṣaśailanātha-dayite dayānidhe! (4)

May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee, O Lakṣmī (i.e., the beloved of the Lord of Vṛṣācala) of eyes like the lotus (petals), (Lakṣmī) of a bright face like (the orbit of) the Moon, (Lakṣmī) worshipped by the wives of Brahmā, Śaṅkara and Indra (i.e., Vāṇī, Girijā and Pulomajā) and (Lakṣmī who is) a treasure of compassion.

atryādi-saptaṛṣayas samupāśya sandhyām
ākāśasindhu-kamalāni manoharāṇi
ādāya pādayugam arcayitum prapannāḥ
śeṣādri-śekhara-vibho! tava suprabhātam (5)

Having worshipped the morning twilight (i.e., having said the morning prayer, namely, the *sandhyāvandana*) the seven sages like Atri, bringing the beautiful lotuses from the Divine Ganges, have arrived to worship Thy feet. Lord of Śeṣācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

pañcānanābjabhava-ṣaṇmukha-vāsavādyāḥ
traivikramādi-caritaṁ vibudhāḥ stuvanti
bhāṣāpatih paṭhati vāsaraśuddhim ārāt
śeṣādri-śekhara-vibho! tava suprabhātam (6)

The Gods Iśvara (the five-faced), Brahmā (the lotus born), Subrahmaṇya (the six-faced), Indra and others are praising stories (deeds) of Your incarnations as the *Trivikramāvatāra*. Near by is Bṛhaspati reading out the planetary position (i.e., *Pañcāṅgam*) of the day. Lord Śeṣācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

īṣatpraphulla-sarasīruha-nārikela-
pūgadrūmādi-sumanohara-pālikānām

āvāti mandam anilaḥ saha divyagandhaiḥ
śeṣādri-śekhara-vibho! tava suprabhātam (7)

The breeze, carrying the wonderful fragrance of the partly opened lotuses and the beautiful ears of the tree like the Areca and Coconut, is gently blowing. Lord of Śeṣācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

unmīlya netrayugam uttama-pañjarasthāḥ
pātrāvaśiṣṭa-kadalīphala-pāyasāni!
bhuktvā salīlam atha keliśukāḥ paṭhanti
śeṣādri-śekhara-vibho! tava suprabhātam (8)

The parrots, kept for pleasure in the foremost cages opening their eyes, are graciously singing, after eating the remains of the plantain fruits and the *pāyasam* in the vessels. Lord Śeṣācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

tantrīprakarṣa-madhurasvanayā vipaṅcyā
gāyaty anantacaritaṁ tava nārado 'pi
bhāṣāsamagram asakṛt-karacāraramyaṁ
śeṣādri-śekhara-vibho! tava suprabhātam (9)

(The sage) Nārada, with (his) *Vīṇā* of sweet music produced by the tight-grip of the strings, is singing in praise of Thy endless deeds, expressed in fine language, by beautifully waving the hand often. Lord of Śeṣācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

bhṛṅgāvalī ca makaranda-rasānuviddha-
jhaṅkāragīta-ninadaiḥ saha sevanāya,
niryāty upānta-sarasī-kamalodarebhyaḥ
śeṣādri-śekhara-vibho! tava suprabhātam (10)

The swarm of bees, making humming sounds, while sucking honey, is emerging from the interiors of the lotuses of the adjoining

pools in order to serve Thee. Lord of Śeṣācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

yoṣā-gaṇena vara-dadhni vimathyamāne
ghoṣālayeṣu dadhimanthana-tivraghoṣāḥ
roṣāt kaliṃ vidadhate kakubhaś ca kumbhāḥ
śeṣādri-śekhara-vibho! tava suprabhātam (11)

While the womenfolk in the hamlet of cowherds churn the fine curds, the high sounds emanating from the pots and their echoes, make the appearance as if the pots and the (eight) directions are engaged in quarrels. Lord of Śeṣācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

padmeśa-mitra-śatapatra-gatālivargāḥ
hartuṃ śriyaṃ kuvalayasya nijāṅga-lakṣmyā
bherī-ninādam iva bibhrati tīvra-nādaṃ
śeṣādri-śekhara-vibho! tava suprabhātam (12)

The swarms of bees in the lotuses which are the friends of the Sun, are making violent sounds as if producing the kettledrum sound with a view to robbing (surpassing) the splendour of the blue lotuses with their (bodily) lustre. Lord of Śeṣācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

śrīmann abhīṣṭa-varadākhila-lokabandho!
śrī-śrīnivāsa! jagadeka-dayaikasindho
śrīdevatā-gr̥ha-bhujāntara-divyamūrte!
śrī-veṅkāṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (13)

One with Lakṣmī! Giver of the desired objects (boons)! Relative (friend) of all the worlds! Abode of Śrī (Lakṣmī)! The matchless ocean of compassion! One having a form charming on account of the chest which is the abode of Śrī (Lakṣmī)! Lord of Veṅkāṭācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

śrīsvāmi-puṣkariṇikā-plava-nirmalāṅgāḥ
śreyo 'rthino hara-viriñci-sanandanādyāḥ
dvāre vasanti varavetra-hatottamāṅgāḥ
śrī-veṅkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (14)

Brahmā, Maheśvara, the sage Sanandana and others, aspiring well-being and having bathed in the Śrīsvāmipuṣkariṇī and (thus) sanctified their bodies, are waiting at the entrance receiving cane-strokes on their heads. Lord of Veṅkaṭācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

śrī-śeṣaśaila-garuḍācala-veṅkaṭādri-
nārāyaṇādri-vṛṣabhādri-vṛṣādri-mukhyām
ākhyām tvadiya-vasater aniśam vadanti
śrī-veṅkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (15)

Lord of Veṅkaṭācala! Thy abode is always called by several names, Śrī Śeṣaśaila, Garuḍācala, Veṅkaṭādri, Nārāyaṇādri, Vṛṣabhādri and Vṛṣādri. May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

sevāparāḥ śiva-sureśa-kṛṣānu-dharma-
rakṣombunātha-pavamāna-dhanādhināthāḥ
baddhāñjali-pravilasan nijaśīrṣa-deśāḥ
śrī-veṅkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (16)

Śiva, Indra, Agni, Yama, Nairuti, Varuṇa, Vāyu and Kubera, with folded hands on their heads, are desirous of offering service to Thee. Lord of Veṅkaṭācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

dhātīṣu te vihagarāja-mṛgādhirāja-
nāgādhirāja-gajarāja-hayādhirājāḥ
svasvādhikāra-mahimādikam arthayante
śrī-veṅkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (17)

Thy conveyances - the Lord of Birds (i.e., Garuḍa), Lord of Animals (i.e., Lion), Lord of Serpents (i.e., Ādi Śeṣa), Lord of Elephants (Airāvata) and Lord of Horses (i.e., Uccaiḥśravā) - are begging (Thee

to grant them) their respective authority, power etc., (to serve Thee better) in Your amusement strolls. Lord of Veṅkaṭācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

sūryendu-bhauma-budha-vākpati-kāvya-sauri-
svarbhānu-ketu-diviṣat-pariṣat-pradhānāḥ
tvaddāsa-dāsa-caramāvadhi-dāsadāsāḥ
śrī-veṅkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (18)

The main (deities) of the Assembly of Gods - the (nine-planets) Sun, Moon, Mars (Aṅāraka), Mercury (Budha), Jupiter (Bṛhaspati), Venus (Śukra), Saturn (Śani), Rāhu and Ketu - remain (happy) to be the servants (i.e., they remain most obedient to Thee). Lord of Veṅkaṭācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

tvat-pādadhūli-bharita-sphuritottamāṅgāḥ
svargāpavarga-nirapekṣa-nijāntaraṅgāḥ
kalpāgamākalanayākulatām labhante
śrī-veṅkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (19)

Lord of Veṅkaṭācala! (Thy servants of devotees), with their heads rendered lustrous (i.e., sanctified) by the dust of Thy feet, do not desire (being in Thy presence) even the Heaven or Liberation and are worried that another Kalpa will start (when there will be no such glory to Veṅkaṭācala). May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

tvad-gopurāgra-śikharāṇi nirīkṣamāṇāḥ
svargāpavarga-padavīm paramām śrayantaḥ
martyā manuṣya-bhuvane matim āśrayante
śrī-veṅkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (20)

Seeing the crests of Thy temple-tower, the mortals, while attaining the exalted paths of Heaven and Liberation, like to live on in the mortal

world (as it gives them the opportunity of worshipping Thee). Lord of Venkaṭācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

śrī-bhūmi-nāyaka! dayādi-guṇāmṛtābdhe!
devādhideva! jagadeka-śaraṇyamūrte!
śrīmann-ananta-garuḍādibhir arcitānghre!
śrī-venkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (21)

Lord of Śrīdevī and Bhūdevī! The ocean of nectar of compassion and other virtues! The chief of Gods! The sole refuge of the Universe! The possessor of Śrī (i.e., wealth)! One whose feet are worshipped by Ananta and Garuḍa! Lord of Venkaṭācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

śrī-padmanābha! puruṣottama! vāsudeva!
vaikuṇṭha mādharma janārdana cakrapāṇe
śrīvatsa-cihna śaraṇāgata-pārijāta
śrī-venkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (22)

Padmanābha! Puruṣottama! Vāsudeva! Vaikuṇṭha! Mādharma! Janārdana! Cakrapāṇi! Bearer of the mole Śrī-vatsa! Celestial tree (*pārijāta*) to those who seek refuge! Lord of Venkaṭācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

kandarpa-darpa-hara-sundara-divyamūrte
kāntā-kucāmburuha-kuṭmala-loladr̥ṣṭe
kālyāṇa-nirmala-guṇākara divyakīrte
śrī-venkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (23)

Bearer of the charming and divine form surpassing the pride of the Cupid (Manmatha)! One whose sight is fondly centred on the lotus-bud-like breasts of His beloved! The abode of auspicious and pure virtues! The possessor of Divine fame! Lord of Venkaṭācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

mīnākṛte kamaṭha kola nṛsimha varṇin
svāmin paraśvatha tapodhana rāmacandra
śeṣāmśarāma yadunandana kalkirūpa
śrī-veṅkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (24)

Lord in (ten) incarnations of *Matsya* (Fish), *Kamaṭha* (Tortoise), *Kola* (Divine Boar), *Nṛsimha* (Man-lion), *Trivikrama* (Dwarf), *Paraśurāma*, *Rāma*, *Balarāma*, *Kṛṣṇa* and *Kalki*! Lord of *Veṅkaṭācala*! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

elā-lavaṅga-ghanasāra-sugandhi-tīrtham
divyaṁ viyat-sariti hema-ghaṭeṣu pūrṇam
dhṛtvādya vaidika-śikhāmaṇayaḥ prahr̥ṣṭāḥ
tiṣṭhanti veṅkaṭapate! tava suprabhātam (25)

The *Brahmins*, well-versed in the *Vedas*, are now joyfully waiting (for worshipping You), carrying the golden pots filled with the waters of the Divine Ganges (*Ākāśa Gaṅgā*) which (waters) are rendered fragrant by (mixing of) the cardamoms, cloves and camphor. Lord of *Veṅkaṭācala*! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

bhāsvān udeti vikacāni saroruhāṇi
saṁpūrayanti ninadaiḥ kakubho vihaṅgāḥ
śrīvaiṣṇavās satatam arthita-maṅgalās te
dhāmāśrayanti tava veṅkaṭa suprabhātam (26)

The sun is rising, the lotuses have blossomed. The birds are filling the directions (*diks*) with their noises. The *Śrī Vaiṣṇavas*, always imploring auspiciousness, are waiting at Thy abode. Lord of *Veṅkaṭācala*! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

brahmādayas suravarās samaharṣayas te
santas sanandana-mukhāstv atha yogivaryāḥ
dhāmāntike tava hi maṅgala-vastu-hastāḥ
śrī-veṅkaṭācalapate! tava suprabhātam (27)

The Chief Gods like Brahmā, the great sages and the good Yogis as Sanandana are (waiting) at Thy abode, holding auspicious things in their hands. Lord of Venkātācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

lakṣmī-nivāsa niravadya-guṇaika-sindho
saṁsāra-sāgara-samuttaraṇaika-seto
vedānta-vedya-nijavaibhava bhaktabhogya
śrī-venkātācalapate! tava suprabhātam (28)

Abode of Lakṣmī! Ocean of faultless (and auspicious) virtues! Bridge to cross the ocean of transmigration (*saṁsāra*)! One whose glory is known through the *Upaniṣads*! One enjoyed by the devotees! Lord of Venkātācala! May it be an auspicious dawn to Thee.

itthaṁ vṛṣācala-pateriha suprabhātaṁ
ye mānavāḥ pratidinam paṭhitum pravṛttāḥ
teṣāṁ prabhāta-samaye smṛtiraṅga-bhājāṁ
prajñāṁ parārtha-sulabhāṁ paramāṁ prasūte (29)

To the people who recite these *Suprabhāta* verses of Lord Venkateśa in this manner (with the understanding of the meaning) during the morning hour, to them the very thought of You grants the utmost intelligence and wisdom which finally lead them to realization of the highest.

Śrī Veṅkaṭeśa Stotram

kamalā-kuca-cūcuka-kuṅkumato
niyatāruṇitātula-nīlatano
kamalāyata-locana lokapate
vijayī bhava veṅkaṭa-śailapate (1)

Lord of Veṅkaṭācala! One whose matchless blue body is ever rendered red by the saffron on the teats of the breasts of Kamalā (i.e., Śrīdevī)! One whose eyes are broad like the petals of the lotus! O Lord of the Universe! Victory to Thee, the Lord of Veṅkaṭācala!

sacaturmukha-ṣaṇmukha-pañcamukha-
pramukhākhila-daivata-maulimaṇe
śaraṇāgatavatsala sāranidhe
paripālaya mām vṛṣa-śailapate (2)

The crest-jewel of all Gods like Brahmā, Kumārasvāmī and Maheśvara! The compassionate to those seeking protection! Protect me, O Lord of Vṛṣaśaila!

ativelatayā tava durviśahair-
anuvēla-kṛtair aparādha-śataiḥ
bharitaṁ tvaritaṁ vṛṣa-śailapate
parayā kṛpayā paripāhi hare (3)

Lord of Vṛṣaśaila! May Thou (O Hari!), with extreme mercy, protect me who always committed various unendurable sins.

adhiveṅkaṭa-śailam udāramater-
janatābhi-matādhika-dānaratāt
paradevatayā gaditān nigamaiḥ
kamalādayitān na param kalaye (4)

I do not consider supreme any one other than the Lord of Kamalā (Śrīdevī), who is liberal-minded (and dwells) on Venkaṭācala, who is intent on granting much more than what is desired by the devotees and who is described by the Vedas as the Supreme God.

kalaveṇu-ravāvaśa-gopavadhū-
śatakoṭi-vṛtāt smarakoṭi samāt
prati-vallavikābhimatāt sukhadāt
vasudeva-sutān na param kalaye (5)

I do not understand any one other than Kṛṣṇa who is surrounded by innumerable cowherdresses (Gopikās) enchanted by the sweet music of (His) flute, who is equal (in beauty) to myriads of Cupids (Manmathas), who gives joy and who is dear to each Gopikā.

abhirāma-guṇākara dāśarathe
jagadeka-dhanurdhara dhīramate
raghunāyaka rāma rameśa vibho
varado bhava deva dayā-jaladhe (6)

Source of enchanting virtues! Rāma! The matchless archer of the Universe! The steady-minded! The best of the Raghu-race! Rameśa! The all-pervading! The ocean of compassion! O Lord! Grant us boons.

avanī-tanayā-kamanīya-karam
rajanīkara-cāru-mukhāmbu-ruham
rajanīcara-rāja-tamo-mihiram
mahanīyam aham raghurāmam aye (7)

I seek refuge of Raghurāma whose hand is desired by Sītā (or that does what Sītā likes), who has a beautiful face like the Moon, who is (like) the Sun (to put an end) to the darkness, ie., Rāvaṇa (the King of Demons) and who is exalted.

sumukhaṁ suhṛdaṁ sulabhaṁ sukhadaṁ
svanujaṁ ca sukāyaṁ amoghaśaraṁ
apahāya raghūdvaḥam anyam ahaṁ
na kathañcana kañcana jātu bhaje (8)

At no time, and in no way, do I worship anyone barring Rāma (who has elevated the Raghu race), who has a handsome face, is good-hearted, easily attainable, has good brothers, has a beautiful body and whose arrows are unfailing.

vinā veṅkaṭeśaṁ na nātho na nāthaḥ
sadā veṅkaṭeśaṁ smarāmi smarāmi
hare veṅkaṭeśa prasīda prasīda
priyaṁ veṅkaṭeśa prayaccha prayaccha (9)

There is no saviour other than Veṅkaṭeśa. I ever pray to (or remember) Veṅkaṭeśa. O Hari, Veṅkaṭeśa! Be pleased; grant (us) favours.

ahaṁ dūratas te padāmbhoja-yugma-
praṇāmeccchayāgatya sevāṁ karomi
sakṛt sevayā nitya-sevāphalaṁ tvaṁ
prayaccha prayaccha prabho veṅkaṭeśa (10)

O Lord! Having come from afar (with a desire to salute Thy lotus-like feet) I am serving Thee Veṅkaṭeśa! (please) give me, for this occasional worship, the reward given to the regular (daily) worship.

ajñāninā mayā doṣān
aśeṣān vihitān hare
kṣamasva tvaṁ kṣamasva tvaṁ
śeṣaśaila-śikhāmaṇe (11)

O Hari! The crest-jewel of Śeṣaśaila! Pardon me for all the sins committed by me, an ignorant.

Śrī Nṛsimha Kavacam

nṛsimha-kavacaṁ vakṣye prahlādenoditaṁ purā
sarva-rakṣā-karaṁ puṇyaṁ sarvopadrava-nāśanam (1)

I shall now recite the Nṛsimha Kavaca, formerly spoken by Prahlāda Mahārāja. It is the most pious, vanquishes all kinds of impediments, and provides one with all protection.

sarva-sampat-karaṁ caiva svarga-mokṣa-pradāyakam
dhyātvā nṛsimhaṁ deveśaṁ hema-simhāsana-sthitam (2)

It bestows upon one all opulences and can give one elevation to the heavenly planets or liberation. One should meditate on Lord Nṛsimha, Lord of the universe, seated upon a golden throne.

vivṛtasyaṁ tri-nayanaṁ śaraḍ-indu-sama-prabham
lakṣmyāliṅgita-vāmāṅgam vibhūtibhir upāśritam (3)

His mouth is wide open, He has three eyes, and He is as radiant as the autumn moon. He holds the Goddess Lakṣmī in an embrace on His left side, and is the resting place for all kinds of prosperity — material and spiritual.

catur-bhujam komalāṅgam svarṇa-kuṇḍala-śobhitam
śriyā su-śobhitoraskam ratna-keyūra-mudritam (4)

The Lord has four arms, and His limbs are very soft. He is decorated with golden earrings. His chest is glowing with Lakṣmī & His arms are adorned with jewel studded ornaments.

tapta-kāñcana-saṅkāśam pīta-nirmala-vāsasam
indrādi-sura-mauliṣṭha sphuran māṇikyā-dīptibhiḥ
virājita-pada-dvandvam śaṅkha-cakrādi-hetibhiḥ
garutmatā ca vinayāt stūyamānam mudānvitam (5 & 6)

He is dressed in a golden yellow garment, which looks like molten gold. His feet are very attractive by the rays emanating from the sparkling rubies on the crowns of Indra and other gods. He is armed with weapons like the Conch, the Discus (assuming forms). Garuḍa joyfully offers prayers with great reverence.

**sva-hṛt-kamala-saṁvāsaṁ kṛtvā tu kavacaṁ paṭhet
nṛsiṁho me śiraḥ pātu loka-rakṣātma-sambhavaḥ (7)**

Having seated Lord Nṛsiṁha upon the lotus of one's heart, one should recite the following *mantra* - "May Lord Nṛsiṁha, who has emerged to protect the entire world, protect my head."

**sarvago 'pi stambha-vāsaḥ phālaṁ me rakṣatu dhvanim
nṛsiṁho me dṛṣau pātu soma-sūryāgni-locanaḥ (8)**

Although the Lord is all-pervading, (for the sake of a devotee), He hid Himself inside a pillar. May He protect my forehead and speech. May He, who has the Sun, the Moon and the Fire as His eyes, protect my eyes.

**smṛtiṁ me pātu nṛhariḥ muni-varya-stuti-priyaḥ
nāsāṁ me siṁha-nāsa tu mukhaṁ lakṣmī-mukha-priyaḥ (9)**

May Lord Nṛhari, who is pleased with the prayers offered by the best of sages, protect my memory. May He who has the nose of a lion protect my nose. May He who is fond of Lakṣmī's mouth, protect my mouth.

**sarva-vidyādhipaḥ pātu nṛsiṁho rasanām mama
vaktraṁ pātv indu-vadanaḥ sadā prahlāda-vanditaḥ (10)**

May Lord Nṛsiṁha, who is superior in all forms of education, protect my sense of taste. May He whose face is as beautiful as the full moon and who is offered prayers by Prahlāda Mahārāja protect my face.

**nṛsimhaḥ pātu me kaṇṭham skandhau bhū-bharaṇānta-kṛt
divyāstra-śobhita-bhujo nṛsimhaḥ pātu me bhujau (11)**

May Lord Nṛsimha protect my throat. He is the sustainer of the earth and the performer of unlimitedly wonderful activities. His shoulders are lustrous with divine weapons. May He protect my shoulders.

**karau me deva-varado nṛsimhaḥ pātu sarvataḥ
hṛdayam yogi-sādhyaś ca nivāsam pātu me hariḥ (12)**

May the Lord, Nṛsimha who showers boons on the demigods, protect my hands and may He protect me from all sides. May Lord Hari who is attained by the yogis protect my heart & my residence.

**madhyam pātu hiraṇyākṣa-vakṣaḥ-kukṣi-vidāraṇaḥ
nābhim me pātu nṛhariḥ sva-nābhi-brahma-saṁstutaḥ (13)**

May Lord Nṛhari who tore open the chest and stomach of the *asura*, Hiraṇyākṣa protect my waist & navel. He is offered prayers by Brahmā who has sprung from His own navel.

**brahmāṇḍa-koṭayaḥ kaṭyām yasyāsau pātu me kaṭim
guhyaṁ me pātu guhyānām mantrāṇām guhya-rūpa-dhṛk (14)**

May Lord Nṛsimha, on whose hips rest all the universes, protect my hips and private parts. He is the knower of all *mantras* and all mysteries, but He Himself is not visible.

**ūrū manobhavaḥ pātu jānunī nara-rūpa-dhṛk
jaṅghe pātu dharā-bhāra-hartā yo 'sau nṛ-keśarī (15)**

May He who is visualized by mind (through meditation) protect my thighs. May He who exhibits a human-like form protect my knees. May the remover of the burden of the earth, Nṛkeśarī protect my calves.

**surā-rājya-pradaḥ pātu pādaḥ me nṛharīśvaraḥ
sahasra-śīrṣā-puruṣaḥ pātu me sarvaśas tanum (16)**

May He who bestows the heavenly kingdom on demigods protect my feet. Nṛhari is the supreme controller, in the form of man-lion. May the thousand headed *puruṣa* protect my body in all respects.

**mahograhā pūrvataḥ pātu mahā-vīrāgrajo 'gnitāḥ
mahā-viṣṇur dakṣiṇe tu mahā-jvālas tu nairṛtau (17)**

May the fierce Lord protect me from the east. May He who is superior to the greatest of heroes protect me from the South East, which is presided over by Agni. May the Supreme Viṣṇu protect me from the South and may that person of effulgent lustre protect me from the South West.

**paścime pātu sarveśo diśi me sarvatomukhaḥ
nṛsimhaḥ pātu vāyavyām saumyām bhīṣaṇa-vigrahaḥ (18)**

May the Lord of everything protect me from the West. He is everywhere and so may He protect me from this direction. May Lord Nṛsimha protect me from the North West, which is presided over by Vāyu. May He whose form is fierce, protect me from the North.

**īśānyām pātu bhadro me sarva-maṅgala-dāyakaḥ
saṁsāra-bhayataḥ pātu mṛtyor mṛtyur nṛ-keśarī (19)**

May He who confers all auspiciousness protect me from the North East, and may Nṛsimha who is death personified protect me from the fears of death & the cycle of being born in the material world.

**idaṁ nṛsimha-kavacaṁ prahlāda-mukha-maṇḍitam
bhaktimān yaḥ paṭhen nityaṁ sarva-pāpaiḥ pramucyate (20)**

This Nṛsimha Kavaca has been recited by Prahlāda himself. A devotee who regularly reads this is freed from all sins.

putravān dhanavān loka dirghāyur upajāyate
yam yam kāmāyate kāmam tam tam prāpnoty asamśayam
sarvatra jayam āpnoti sarvatra vijayī bhavet
bhūmy antarikṣa-divyānām grahāṇām vinivāraṇam (21)

(By reciting this) one may obtain sons, wealth, a long life in this world and attain all that one desires. There is no doubt about this. If one desires victory, he will become victorious and be able to ward off the evil effects of all planets both earthly & heavenly.

vṛścikoraḡa-sambhūta-viṣāpaharaṇam param
brahma-rākṣasa-yakṣāṇām dūrotsāraṇa-kāraṇam (22)

He will also be able to remove the poison of scorpions and snakes and will drive away fierce *rākṣasas* and *yakṣas* to a great distance.

bhūrje vā tālapatre vā kavacaṁ likhitaṁ śubham
kara-mūle dhṛtaṁ yena sidhyeyuḥ karma-siddhayaḥ (23)

One may inscribe this prayer on a *bhūrja* leaf or a palm leaf and attach it to the wrist. Then, all his actions will bear fruit.

devāsura-manuṣyeṣu svam svam eva jayam labhet
eka-sandhyaṁ tri-sandhyaṁ vā yaḥ paṭhen niyato naraḥ (24)

He who recites this prayer, regularly, once daily or thrice daily will become victorious whether among men, *asuras* or demigods.

sarva-maṅgaḡa-māṅgaḡyaṁ bhuktiṁ muktiṁ ca vindati
dvā-triṁśati-sahasraṇi paṭhec chuddhātmabhir nṛbhiḥ (25)

He who with pure heart recites this prayer 32,000 times will obtain the most auspicious of all auspicious things, material enjoyment and (ultimately) liberation.

**kavacasyāśya mantrasya mantra-siddhiḥ prajāyate
anena mantra-rājena kṛtvā bhasmābhi mantraṇam (26)**

This Nṛsimha Kavaca Mantra is the king of all *mantras* & will grant all things. One attains by it what would be attained by anointing oneself with ashes and chanting all other *mantras*.

**tilakaṁ bibhryād yas tu tasya graha-bhayaṁ haret
tri-vāraṁ japamānas tu dattaṁ vāryabhimantrya ca (27)**

If one applies the distinct mark on the forehead (*Tilaka*), with these ashes, sips water in the prescribed manner (*ācamana*) and recites this mantra thrice, the fear of inauspicious planets is removed.

**prāśayed yaṁ naraṁ mantraṁ nṛsimha-dhyānamācaret
tasya rogāḥ praṇaśyanti ye ca syuḥ kukṣi-sambhavāḥ (28)**

One who meditates on Lord Nṛsimha and recites this *mantra* will be able to rid himself of his abdominal and other diseases.

**kimatra bahunoktena nṛsimha-saḍṛśo bhavet
manasā cintitaṁ yat tu sa tac cāpnoty asaṁśayam (29)**

Why should more be said? One acquires qualitative oneness with Nṛsimha Himself. There is no doubt that the desires in the mind of one who meditates will be granted.

**garjantaṁ garjayantaṁ nija-bhuja-pāṭalaṁ sphoṭayantaṁ harantaṁ
dīpyantaṁ tāpayantaṁ divi bhuvi ditijaṁ kṣepayantaṁ kṣipantaṁ
(30)**

**krandantaṁ roṣayantaṁ diśi diśi satataṁ saṁharantaṁ bharantaṁ
vikṣantaṁ ghūrṇayantaṁ kara-nikara-śatair divya-simhaṁ
namāmi (31)**

Lord Nṛsimha roars and causes others to roar. He splashes His

many arms and tears apart the *asuras*. He seeks and destroys the descendants of Diti, wherever they be, in this world or in higher spheres. He throws them down & makes others also do the same. He screams in anger & makes others also angry. He destroys the demons and takes them away. He stares at them and makes them reel. He has hundreds of hands & I offer my respectful obeisances to the Lord, who has assumed the form of a transcendental lion.

iti śrī-brahmāṇḍa-purāṇe prahlādoktaṁ
śrī-nṛsimha-kavacaṁ sampūrṇam.

Thus ends the Nṛsimha Kavaca as it is described by Prahlāda Mahārāja in the Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa Aṣṭottara Śata Nāmāvali

1. Om śrī kṛṣṇāya namaḥ
2. Om kamalā nāthāya namaḥ
3. Om vāsudevāya namaḥ
4. Om sanātanāya namaḥ
5. Om vasudevātmajāya namaḥ
6. Om puṇyāya namaḥ
7. Om līlā mānuṣa vighrahāya namaḥ
8. Om śrīvatsa kaustubha dharāya namaḥ
9. Om yaśodā vatsalāya namaḥ
10. Om haraye namaḥ
11. Om caturbhujāta cakrāsi gadā śaṅkhādya yudhāya namaḥ
12. Om devakī nandanāya namaḥ
13. Om śrīśāya namaḥ
14. Om nandagopa priyātmajāya namaḥ
15. Om yamunāvega saṁhāriṇe namaḥ
16. Om balabhadra priyānujāya namaḥ
17. Om pūtanā jīvītāpa harāya namaḥ
18. Om śakaṭāsura bhañjanāya namaḥ
19. Om nanda vraja janānandine namaḥ
20. Om saccidānanda vighrahāya namaḥ
21. Om navanīta vilīptāṅgāya namaḥ
22. Om navanīta varāya namaḥ
23. Om anaghāya namaḥ

24. Om navanīta navāhāriṇe namaḥ
25. Om mucukunda prasādakāya namaḥ
26. Om ṣoḍaśa strī sahasreśāya namaḥ
27. Om tribhaṅgine namaḥ
28. Om madhurākṛtaye namaḥ
29. Om śuka vāgamṛtābdhīndave namaḥ
30. Om govindāya namaḥ
31. Om yoginām pataye namaḥ
32. Om vatsavāṭa carāya namaḥ
33. Om anantāya namaḥ
34. Om dhenukāsura bhañjanāya namaḥ
35. Om tṛṇīkṛta tṛṇāvartāya namaḥ
36. Om yamalārjuna bhañjanāya namaḥ
37. Om uttāla tāla bhetre namaḥ
38. Om gopa gopīśvarāya namaḥ
39. Om yogine namaḥ
40. Om koṭisūrya samaprabhāya namaḥ
41. Om ilāpataye namaḥ
42. Om paramjyotiṣe namaḥ
43. Om yādavendrāya namaḥ
44. Om yadūdvaḥāya namaḥ
45. Om vanamāline namaḥ
46. Om pītavāsine namaḥ
47. Om pārijātāpahārakāya namaḥ
48. Om govardhanācaloddhartre namaḥ

49. Om gopālāya namaḥ
50. Om sarva pālakāya namaḥ
51. Om ajāya namaḥ
52. Om nirañjanāya namaḥ
53. Om kāmajanakāya namaḥ
54. Om kañja locanāya namaḥ
55. Om madhughne namaḥ
56. Om mathurā nāthāya namaḥ
57. Om dvārakā nāyakāya namaḥ
58. Om baline namaḥ
59. Om vṛndāvanānta sañcāriṇe namaḥ
60. Om tulasī dāma bhūṣaṇāya namaḥ
61. Om syamantaka maṇi hartre namaḥ
62. Om nara nārāyaṇātmaśāyā namaḥ
63. Om kubjā kṛṣṇāmbara dharāya namaḥ
64. Om māyine namaḥ
65. Om parama puruṣāya namaḥ
66. Om muṣṭikāsura cāṇūra-malla yuddha viśāradāya namaḥ
67. Om saṁsāra vairiṇe namaḥ
68. Om kaṁsāraye namaḥ
69. Om murāraye namaḥ
70. Om narakāntakāya namaḥ
71. Om anādi brahmacāriṇe namaḥ
72. Om kṛṣṇā vyasana karṣakāya namaḥ
73. Om śiśupāla śiraś chetre namaḥ

74. Om duryodhana kulāntakāya namaḥ
75. Om vidurākrūra varadāya namaḥ
76. Om viśvarūpa pradarśakāya namaḥ
77. Om satyavāce namaḥ
78. Om satya saṅkalpāya namaḥ
79. Om satyabhāmā ratāya namaḥ
80. Om jayine namaḥ
81. Om subhadrā pūrvajāya namaḥ
82. Om jīṣṇave namaḥ
83. Om bhīṣma muktupradāyakāya namaḥ
84. Om jagadgurave namaḥ
85. Om jagannāthāya namaḥ
86. Om veṇunāda viśāradāya namaḥ
87. Om vṛṣabhāsura vidhvamsine namaḥ
88. Om bāṇāsura karāntakāya namaḥ
89. Om yudhiṣṭhira pratiṣṭhātre namaḥ
90. Om barhi barhāvataṁsakāya namaḥ
91. Om pārtha sārathaye namaḥ
92. Om avyaktāya namaḥ
93. Om gītāmṛta mahodadhave namaḥ
94. Om kālīya phaṇi māṇikyā rañjita śrīpadāmbujāya namaḥ
95. Om dāmodarāya namaḥ
96. Om yajña bhoktre namaḥ
97. Om dānavendra vināśakāya namaḥ
98. Om nārāyaṇāya namaḥ

99. Om parabrahmaṇe namaḥ
100. Om pannagāśana vāhanāya namaḥ
101. Om jalakrīḍā samāśakta gopī vastrāpahārakāya namaḥ
102. Om puṇya ślokāya namaḥ
103. Om tīrthapādāya namaḥ
104. Om veda vedyāya namaḥ
105. Om dayā nidhaye namaḥ
106. Om sarva tīrthātmakāya namaḥ
107. Om sarvagraha rūpiṇe namaḥ
108. Om parātparāya namaḥ

How to read and write Sanskrit using the English alphabet

In this book, Sanskrit words are spelt by an internationally recognised standard phonetic system using diacritical marks that lets you know how to pronounce each word. The Sanskrit alphabet is represented thus:

अ	आ	इ	ई	उ	ऊ	ऋ	ॠ	ऌ
a	ā	i	ī	u	ū	r̥	r̄	l̥
ए	ऐ	ओ	औ	अं	अः			
e	ai	o	au	aṁ	aḥ			
क	ख	ग	घ	ङ				
ka	kha	ga	gha	ṅa				
च	छ	ज	झ	ञ				
ca	cha	ja	jha	ña				
ट	ठ	ड	ढ	ण				
ṭa	ṭha	ḍa	ḍha	ṇa				
त	थ	द	ध	न				
ta	tha	da	dha	na				
प	फ	ब	भ	म				
pa	pha	ba	bha	ma				
य	र	ल	व	श	ष	स	ह	
ya	ra	la	va	śa	ṣa	sa	ha	

Example: राम is written as Rāma. कृष्ण is written as Kṛṣṇa.

वृन्दावन is written as Vṛndāvana.